

Programme presentation in Brazil
Trias
DGD 2027-2031

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I. Presentation of the programme in Brazil

A. Basic information

Title of the programme in this country:	Strengthening inclusive, sustainable and resilient ecosystems through organised family entrepreneurs in Brazil
Short title:	Trias 27-31 Brazil

B. Contacts

1. Contact details of the reference person in the country

Name	Gisele Sayuri Obara
Telephone	+55 41 99613 2941
Email	gisele.obara@trias.ngo

C. Key facts about the programme in this country

1. General

o Title and OECD-DAC sectors

Title of the outcome – French/English:	Strengthening inclusive, sustainable and resilient ecosystems through organised family entrepreneurs in Brazil		
Main sector:	31194 Agricultural co-operatives (Including farmers' organisations)	Budget share	70%
Secondary sectors:	25030 Business development services e.g. incubators, business strategies, commercial linkages programmes and matchmaking services. Includes support to e.g. waste picker cooperatives	Budget share	30%

o Objectives

JSF:

Relevant strategic JSF objective(s):	N/A
Approaches or Sub-objectives:	

Non-JSF: To confirm

Objectives:	Objective 1: To strengthen inclusive and democratic governance, with gender parity and youth inclusive participation in decision-making processes
	Objective 2: To promote inclusive sustainable new economies towards inequalities and disparities reductions, by fostering the social, solidarity, innovation and climate resilience
	Objective 3: To reinforce the stakeholder ecosystem joining effort among the resilience, sustainable Amazon bio corridor biodiversity
	Objective 4: To develop strategic skills to reduce the structural gaps, guaranteeing a more inclusive, equitable and digitally connected, and that it promotes social innovation, decent work and sustainability

2. Geographical location of the partners' intervention zone(s)

Partner name	Name of the action area of the MBO	GPS coordinates (latitude - longitude)
CSA Brasil	200 urban CSA units in 19 (of 27) states, national level	HQ: 22°19'00"S – 49°04'31"W

UNICAFES ¹ Pará	13 rural municipalities of Pará, Amazon Northern Brazil region, state level	HQ: 1°21'59"S – 48°22'20"W
UNICATADORES	230 urban waste pickers cooperatives in 26 (of 27) states, national level	HQ: 23°32'51"S – 46°38'10"W
UNICAFES Rondônia	15 rural municipalities of Rondônia state, Amazon Northern Brazil region, state level	HQ: 10°52'51"S – 61°56'31' W

3. Summary of the country programme

○ Programme formulation

Trias cooperates with Member Based Organisations and other strategic partners to build more inclusive, sustainable, and resilient entrepreneurial ecosystems in Brazil. To this end, Trias facilitates Organisational Development processes of these MBOs, aiming at more (i) equity and shared power; (ii) sustainable and climate-resilient practices; and (iii) inclusive and resilient economic models in which women, youth and other underprivileged entrepreneurs can participate and thrive.

○ Brief description of the programme

From 2027 to 2031, Trias aims to transform **the Amazonian (socio)bioeconomy ecosystems** by strengthening MBOs as drivers of inclusion and resilience. We empower family entrepreneurs to lead sustainable value chains with inclusive cooperatives and innovation, fostering climate adaptation. To tackle increasing vulnerability and migration, our strategy expands to include the **circular economy for waste pickers entrepreneurs**, the promotion of decent work, and the **scaling of community-supported agriculture** into this holistic approach.

The basis of our intervention is grounded in four main pillars: OS-ID strengthening of rural-urban MBOs; transformative (eco)system change; an integrated People–Planet–Profit approach; and a decolonial pathway based on mutual learning and co-creation.

Together with **four rural-urban MBOs partners** (UNICAFES Pará, UNICAFES Rondônia, CSA Brasil and UNICATADORES), the main pathway is **OS-ID strengthening** through accompaniment (technical advisory, institutional facilitation, catalytic funding, and complementary initiatives). Partners MBOs will improve their governance and accountability; financial management; member services; advocacy and partnerships; and monitoring, evaluation, and learning—enabling them to deliver quality services at scale and sustain results beyond project cycles.

Based on a systems thinking approach, Trias and the MBOs intend to **co-create and strengthen the stakeholders (eco)system**, leveraging resources and amplifying new ways of collaboration and synergies.

Nevertheless, the premise of an **integrated 3Ps approach** (People-Planet-Profit) guarantees that we leave no behind in terms of excluded people (especially women and young people), linking crosscutting strategies to safeguard biodiversity and climate resilience with economic sustainability.

For effectiveness, results will be tracked through **measurable changes** in MBOs performance and accountability. Trias will maintain transparent monitoring, evaluation, and learning, document replicable practices, and report outcomes and assumptions in line with DGD requirements.

○ Detailed description of the programme

Trias Worldwide and South America Regional strategies

As a global organisation, Trias contributes to systemic change by strengthening member-based organizations (MBOs) as key players within their ecosystems. Through a transformative

¹ State-level UNICAFES affiliate in the Brazilian Amazon. Its mandate is to support affiliated family-farming cooperatives and associations in organisational strengthening, business generation and commercialisation. Participating affiliates are present in different municipalities across the state

approach, Trias addresses the root causes of inequality, exclusion and environmental degradation, while promoting inclusive, resilient and sustainable systems.

The basis of corporate intervention is grounded in **four main pillars**: OS-ID strengthening of rural-urban MBOs; transformative (eco)system change; an integrated People–Planet–Profit approach; and a decolonial pathway based on mutual learning and co-creation.

The strategic thematic priorities—environment & climate, inclusion and economic development—are fully integrated and mutually reinforcing. Through this integrated approach, Trias aims to create lasting systemic change, empowering individuals and organisations to act as drivers of inclusive and sustainable development.

The Trias South America long-standing collaboration with MBO partners and the broader ecosystem has allowed the regional approach to have: (i) Join efforts in the **Amazon bioeconomy corridor**, connecting selected MBOs of Brazil, Ecuador, Peru (with special attention to strategic Amazon chains cocoa, coffee and Amazonian agroforestry systems); (ii) **Peer-learning trajectories** in specific MBOs demands (e.g. due-diligence and traceability, cooperative-based business models, and inclusive governance mechanisms); (iii) **Trias’ regional identity and thematic harmonic pathways among the three countries**, ensuring coherence and mutual reinforcement towards common methodologies, tools, and solutions; and (iv) **Foster cross-country knowledge**, enhancing efficiency, innovation, and opportunities for joint advocacy within the Amazon region.

Theory of Change of the Brazil Programme

Aligned to corporate and regional strategy, Trias Brazil reaffirms the commitment to tackling **poverty, systemic inequalities, and climate vulnerability** by positioning Brazilian MBOs at the centre of inclusive, sustainable and future-oriented development. Building on over two decades of experience in Brazil on solidarity cooperativism model and acknowledging the country’s continental scale and regional contrasts, the new programme introduces **clear strategic choices, greater geographic focus, and a more coherent operational model** than the current DGD cycle.

From 2027 to 2031, Trias aims to transform **the Amazonian bioeconomy ecosystems** by strengthening MBOs as drivers of inclusion and resilience. We empower family entrepreneurs to lead sustainable value chains with inclusive cooperatives and innovation, fostering climate adaptation. To tackle increasing vulnerability and migration, our strategy expands to include the **circular economy for waste pickers entrepreneurs**, the promotion of decent work, and the **scaling of community-supported agriculture** into this holistic approach.

Together with **rural-urban MBOs partners** the main pathway is **OS-ID strengthening** through accompaniment (technical advisory, institutional facilitation, catalytic funding, and complementary initiatives). Partners MBOs will improve their governance and accountability; financial management; member services; advocacy and partnerships; and monitoring, evaluation, and learning—enabling them to deliver quality services at scale and sustain results beyond project cycles.

Aligned to the OS/ID institutional development of our MBOs partners, the **Trias’ integrated approach** (3 Ps) is interdependent and mark a **shift from broader thematic diversity to a focused, synergistic agenda**. In more detail, Trias aims to address the following elements:

- On **People**, focus to **Digital connectivity, AI innovation and future skills**, addressing: (i) connectivity, AI literacy, job displacement (especially in urban settings); (ii) acceleration of innovation and tech-enabled entrepreneurship (connected to bio and circular economies); (iii) women’s and youth empowerment, leadership, and inclusive governance structural; (iv) collaborations with start-up & entrepreneurship hubs, incubators and accelerators.
- On **Planet**, focus to **Climate resilience, biodiversity and sustainable food systems**, supporting: (i) locally led climate solutions in rural-urban territories; (ii) critical transition to sustainable food systems in the Amazon corridor; (iii) climate migration responses (SAF, biodynamic); and innovation and entrepreneurial ecosystems.
- On **Profit**, focus to **Economic stability, inclusion and sustainable local ecosystems**, strengthening: (i) stakeholders ecosystem; (ii) Amazon bioeconomy, urban recycling circular

economy, and new economies towards sustainable stability and rural-urban inclusive businesses; and (iii) innovative opportunities (attention to EU-Mercosur agreement).

To move beyond pilots and good practices, Trias supports **structured peer learning across MBOs** to test, document, and replicate proven approaches. Partners agree on shared minimum conditions (e.g., governance safeguards, climate risk screening, inclusive service design) and adapt these across contexts (extending to MBOs partners in South America Trias region). This accelerates uptake, lowers the cost of innovation for less mature MBOs, and creates consistent signals to markets and public actors.

The programme complements MBOs capacities by engaging key partnerships that enable system change. In **mutual co-creation with MBOs partners**, Trias strengthens the **stakeholder ecosystem**, amplifying the joint efforts among relevant actors from private sector, local authorities & policy makers, multilateral organisations, academy & research institutes, and the civil society to unlock technical support, climate and green finance, market access, and pathways for policy uptake. Trias acts as a facilitator and broker to align incentives and maintain accountability to inclusion and environmental safeguards.

Nevertheless, the programme operationalizes a **decolonization pathway**, through co-creation, mutual learning, and partner-led decision-making. In detail, it includes transparent roles and trade-offs, investment in local knowledge and leadership (with gender and inclusivity lens), and practical safeguards to support meaningful participation. Given local power dynamics and potential civic space constraints, MBOs strengthen internal accountability mechanisms, including clear grievance pathways and measures to protect underrepresented members.

The results are measured **at three linked levels**: (1) key individuals in MBOs improve the capacity to lead inclusive, climate-smart and sustainable decisions; (2) MBOs improve their capabilities and performance (on governance, financial health, service reach and quality, peer learning, advocacy and partnerships); and (3) members adopt nature-positive and resilient practices and experience improved livelihood security, reduced climate/disaster risk, and increased voice in MBO and local decision-making. These changes align with the main outcome and operationalize the 3 key results in Section D.

The programme **key assumptions** in this result chain are: (i) Ownership and local leadership, (ii) Institutionalisation of inclusion (women and youth), (iii) Co-creation and equal partnerships, (iv) Public-private-academic partnerships are viable and sustained, (v) Climate and environmental conditions do not catastrophically disrupt operations, (vi) AI and digital transformation do not deepen exclusion, (vii) Financial sustainability and resource mobilisation. The **key risks** include leadership turnover; gender-based barriers; political instability; severe climate events; digital and AI-driven exclusion, civic space constraints, and policy or market shifts. The **programme mitigates the key risks** through a governance strengthening, including a succession planning and knowledge management; progressive financial autonomy via service-based models; leadership development planning; safeguards for equal partnerships, shared accountability; diversification of income and advocacy to manage political volatility; climate contingency planning; digital literacy and co-designed tools; and long-term sustainability and resilient business models.

What it is new for this programme?

In the next five-year cycle, Trias shifts to a more focused and catalytic strategy, concentrating on fewer strategic MBO partners and **priority geographies** to maximise systemic impact. The programme moves from broad thematic coverage to **three integrated pillars (3Ps)** while **deepening rural-urban linkages across the Amazon bio-corridor and major urban centres**. Trias further reduces its role as a financier and strengthens its positioning as **facilitator, connector and catalyst**, with greater emphasis on **regional coherence**, structured peer learning, digital and AI-enabled innovation, women and youth leadership, climate transition and blended finance. Clearer partnership differentiation and planned exit pathways enhance partner autonomy, scalability and long-term sustainability.

[Link to the Sustainable Development Goals \(SDGs\)](#)

The Trias programme contributes to the SDGs by promoting inclusive, nature-positive enterprise systems led by MBOs. It prioritises **SDG 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth)** by strengthening sustainable entrepreneurship, resilient livelihoods and quality jobs through improved MBO governance, service delivery and market engagement, guided by People–Planet–Profit standards. **SDG 5 (Gender Equality)** and **SDG 13 (Climate Action)** are treated as mandatory requirements, embedded through inclusive governance, reduced participation barriers for women and youth, climate-risk screening and nature-based solutions. This integrated approach also advances **SDG 2 (Zero Hunger)**, **SDG 10 (Reduced Inequalities)**, **SDG 16 (Strong Institutions)** and **SDG 17 (Partnerships)** by reinforcing accountable member-led organisations and enabling partnerships that unlock finance, markets and policy impact at scale

MBOs Partners choice and ecosystem

Trias will implement the DGD programme with four MBOs, working with a differentiated but coherent portfolio related to maturity, systemic role, regional mandate and co-financing potential: **UNICAFES Pará, UNICAFES Rondônia, CSA Brasil, and UNICATADORES.**

The programme **concentrates** in the rural Amazonian region through the state-level UNICAFES affiliates in **Pará and Rondônia**, strengthening the Amazon bioeconomy and ensuring the link between biodiversity, market access, climate resilience and value addition. In detail, in Pará state (representing for itself 41 times the size of Belgium), focus on their services delivered, businesses development and markets dynamics, and technical capacity building & training – all based on the 3Ps integrated approach. UNICAFES Rondônia remains part of the programme until 2028, with a **transition pathway**. Their role is to capitalise and transfer previous lessons learned to the broader programme, enhancing the Amazon focus with Pará and Rondonia as part of a wider learning trajectory on state-level cooperative strengthening in the Amazon.

Urban work remains a complementary pathway, together with CSA Brasil and UNICATADORES, to connect the **community-supported agriculture systems with food and nutrition education**; and the urban **recycling circular economy and decent work**. Focus on the strengthening of producer-consumer relations and awareness capacity building, waste-picker cooperative services, environmental services contribution and amplifying public-private-academic collaborations to generate economic stability and new businesses. Special attention to urban women and youngsters in vulnerable situations, in response to structural challenges of inequality, job disruption, and climate-related displacement.

Besides, an opportunity to **amplify the cooperativism model within the recycling sector**, by strengthening recycling cooperatives alongside agricultural ones, under the shared umbrella organisation of **UNICOPAS (National Union of Solidarity-Based Cooperative Organisations)**. Organisation founded in 2014 by 4 main MBOs' systems: UNICAFES (family farming), UNISOL (solidarity economy entrepreneurs), CONCRAB (agrarian reform settlement), and UNICATADORES (waste pickers), where each represents a specific target group of cooperatives.

CRESOL and **UNICAFES National** shift toward equal stakeholder partnership, peer learning, financial linkages, lobby and advocacy, and resource mobilization.

○ *Target groups*

Our *direct* target group are a selected mix of urban, rural, national and state Member-Based Organisations (MBOs) of family entrepreneurs and non-family entrepreneurs (*including cooperatives and associations*). We focus on the one hand on MBOs of smallholder farmers, as well as waste pickers entrepreneurs that do not derive their income from farming or farming related activities. Our *indirect* target group are the member-entrepreneurs of these MBOs.

4. Sensitive and confidential information

(not applicable for Trias)

5. Classification: Sustainable Development Goals

Main SDG:	SDG 8: Promote sustainable, inclusive and sustainable economic growth, full and productive employment a decent work for all
Description Target:	8.2 Achieve higher levels of economic productivity through diversification, technological upgrading and innovation, including through a focus on high-value added and labour-intensive sectors 8.3 Promote development-oriented policies that support productive activities, decent job creation, entrepreneurship, creativity and innovation, and encourage the formalization and growth of micro-, small- and medium-sized enterprises, including through access to financial services 8.5 By 2030, achieve full and productive employment and decent work for all women and men, including for young people and persons with disabilities, and equal pay for work of equal value 8.6 By 2020, substantially reduce the proportion of youth not in employment, education or training 8.10 Strengthen the capacity of domestic financial institutions to encourage and expand access to banking, insurance and financial services for all

Additional SDG:	Goal 5 Achieve gender equality and empower all women and girls
Target description:	5.1 End all forms of discrimination against all women and girls everywhere 5.5 Ensure women's full and effective participation and equal opportunities for leadership at all levels of decision-making in political, economic and public life 5.c. Adopt and strengthen sound policies and enforceable legislation for the promotion of gender equality and the empowerment of all women and girls at all levels

Additional SDG:	Goal 2 End hunger, achieve food security and improved nutrition and promote sustainable agriculture
Target description:	2.3 By 2030, double the agricultural productivity and incomes of small-scale food producers, in particular women, indigenous peoples, family farmers, pastoralists and fishers, including through secure and equal access to land, other productive resources and inputs, knowledge, financial services, markets and opportunities for value addition and non-farm employment. 2.4 By 2030, ensure sustainable food production systems and implement resilient agricultural practices that increase productivity and production, that help maintain ecosystems, that strengthen capacity for adaptation to climate change, extreme weather, drought, flooding and other disasters and that progressively improve land and soil quality. 2.A Increase investment, including through enhanced international cooperation, in rural infrastructure, agricultural research and extension services, technology development and plant and livestock gene banks in order to enhance agricultural productive capacity in developing countries, in particular least developed countries.

Additional SDG:	Goal 10 Reduce inequality within and among countries
Description Target:	10.2 By 2030, empower and promote the social, economic and political inclusion of all, irrespective of age, sex, disability, race, ethnicity, origin, religion or economic or other status.

Additional SDG:	Goal 16 Promote peaceful and inclusive societies for sustainable development, provide access to justice for all and build effective, accountable and inclusive institutions at all levels
Description Target:	16.6 Develop effective, accountable and transparent institutions at all levels. 16.7 Ensure responsive, inclusive, participatory and representative decision-making at all levels.

6. Classification: Markers & Tags

○ *Markers*

Theme	Choice: 0 – 1 – 2
1) Gender	2
2) Environment:	2
3) Participatory development/good governance:	2
4) Trade development:	1
5) Biodiversity:	1
6) Climate change - Mitigation:	1
7) Climate change - Adaptation:	2
8) Desertification:	1
9) RMNCH - Reproductive, Maternal, Newborn and Child Health:	0
10) HIV/AIDS:	0
11) Children's rights:	0

○ *Tags*

Theme	Yes/No
D4D – Better use of big data:	Yes
D4D – Digital for inclusive societies:	Yes
D4D – Digital for inclusive and sustainable economic growth:	Yes
Private Sector Development:	Yes
Health – Sexual and reproductive health:	No
Health – Quality medicines:	No
Health – Health financing and Universal Health Coverage:	No
Refugees:	No

7. Strategic priorities and methodological approaches

a) Strategic thematic priorities

○ *Climate and biodiversity*

Climate and ecological sustainability are transversal to the programme's objectives and implementation approach, especially in the Amazon bio corridor in Brazil. Trias' organisational development methodology, grounded in an integrated **People–Planet–Profit** framework, embeds climate and environmental sustainability across programmes, governance, and internal management. Advancing social justice therefore requires an explicit focus on **environmental and climate justice**, particularly for groups most exposed to climate and ecological risks.

Strengthening adaptation and resilience of MBOs partners

The programme focuses on strengthening the adaptive capacity of partner MBOs – UNICAFES Pará and Rondônia, CSA Brasil, UNICATADORES – and their members to better prepare for, absorb, and recover from climate and environmental shocks. Interventions cover both **Amazonian rural territories** (Pará state, 41 times the size of Belgium) and **urban metropolitan contexts**, notably São Paulo and Rio de Janeiro.

Adaptation processes begin with targeted sensitisation and awareness-building training, combining local climate risk perceptions—particularly those of women, youth, and other underserved entrepreneurs—with climate measurement data. This participatory analysis informs feasible, context-specific adaptation actions and reduces the risk of adaptation. Adaptation plans and advocacy agendas (based on Building Resilience and FACT tools) will be co-designed with MBOs members, leading to re-engineered services, strengthened organisational resilience, and improved representation in climate-related policy dialogue.

Nevertheless, Trias also will promote exchanges and learning trajectories based on peer-to-peer logic and knowledge capitalisation.

Family-farmers' cooperatives and biodiversity protection in the Amazon

In rural Amazonian context, no different in Pará state, the programme invests in **natural ecosystems and biodiversity as a foundation for sustainable agricultural and rural development**. Long-term conservation of Amazon bio corridors and forest ecosystems is constrained by limited and unstable financing, which weakens governance, continuity, and local ownership. Sustaining ecological connectivity across large forest landscapes requires locally anchored stewardship models that go beyond short-term interventions.

Family-farmer and their cooperatives play a key role as **guardians of biodiversity**, yet they face limited technical capacity, weak integration into conservation governance, and insufficient ecosystem services. Economic pressures may therefore drive unsustainable land-use practices. The programme strengthens cooperative-based models that integrate biodiversity conservation, climate resilience, and within sustainable bioeconomy businesses.

The programme will promote **public–academic–private partnerships** to integrate research and development into biodiversity-friendly value chains. Applied innovation spaces support the valorisation of Amazonian biodiversity in higher-value markets. E.g. the complementary initiatives with: (i) IDB Bank, AWEX and Liege University on the Gastronomy Lab programme in Santarém-Pará; (ii) Colruyt Group, Suzano, CERTI, SEBRAE MG, and PSA on the beekeeping and youth inclusion project in Pará, Tocantins, Minas Gerais states; and (iii) The Nature Conservancy, PSA, FVVP and other UNICAFES Pará stakeholders ecosystem, supporting the expansion of cooperativism in the state since its constitution in 2024. Besides, the access to **Payment for Environmental Services (PES), carbon markets, and REDD+ mechanisms** will be expanded through simplified monitoring systems and engagement of local actors (though MBO tailormade services delivered to their members).

Urban resilience and waste-pickers' cooperatives

In urban settings, waste-pickers' cooperatives affiliated with UNICATADORES operate in infrastructures increasingly exposed to **extreme heat and flooding**, which threaten workers' health and reduce the quality and value of recyclable materials. Despite their contribution to climate mitigation and biodiversity protection, these organisations **remain largely invisible as environmental actors** and are **often excluded from climate finance** due to the lack of recognised impact metrics.

The programme will support, together with the stakeholder ecosystem of UNICATADORES, pilots on the transition from weight-based sales models to **Payment for Ecosystem Services (PES)** approaches, enabled by monitoring technologies that demonstrate waste diversion from sensitive ecosystems and measurable reductions in the recycling sector's carbon footprint. Within an **Inclusive Circular Economy** framework, investments in renewable energy, improved logistics, and technological modernisation of sorting hubs reposition waste pickers as key actors in urban resilience and environmental protection.

Systemic impact

By strengthening the MBO's capacities on climate resilience, amplifying their stakeholder ecosystems and new partnerships, it contributes to more **sustainable and inclusive food systems**, improved food and social security, and greater economic stability. By reducing environmental degradation, resource-related vulnerabilities, and social exclusion, the approach also supports **peaceful and resilient communities** in both rural and urban contexts. Climate and environmental sustainability are progressively institutionalised within MBO cultures, policies, and practices, while Trias itself advances its role as a change agent through an internal sustainability and carbon-reduction roadmap.

- *Global health*

While the Programme does not focus on direct clinical interventions or national healthcare infrastructure, it contributes indirectly to Global Health by addressing key structural determinants of health **within food healthy systems**. Our economic and environmental interventions—centred on strengthening of rural member-based organisations such as UNICAFES and Community Supported Agriculture (CSA) — improve the livelihoods of member-entrepreneurs through increased income, better savings, and secure access to land.

These outcomes **indirectly foster food security and psychological stability** for organized entrepreneurs and their families, while reducing long-term non-communicable diseases (NCD) risk factors through improved access to agroecological food. By enhancing territorial resilience and shortening food supply chains, the Programme supports a preventive approach to health, contributing to more equitable and stable communities without detracting from the primary focus on sustainable entrepreneurship.

- *Stability (governance, justice, human mobility, resilience, equality & local economic development)*

Brazil faces persistent territorial imbalances, with concentrated urbanisation alongside poverty and **institutional fragility in rural and forest territories**, particularly in the Amazon region. These disparities generate interconnected social, economic and governance instabilities, including distress-driven **rural out-migration, urban informality**, land tenure insecurity, income volatility and limited access to markets, credit and public programmes. **Informal waste pickers and family farmers entrepreneurs**—both central to local economies and service provision—are disproportionately affected, with gender and racial inequalities further compounding vulnerability, especially in geographically isolated areas. High logistical costs and infrastructure gaps, commonly referred to as the “**Amazon Cost**”, constrain diversification and sustainable bioeconomy development, increasing exposure to economic, climatic and social shocks and undermining long-term territorial stability.

In this context, Trias addresses these root causes by strengthening rural-urban MBOs as inclusive, accountable, and representative institutions, reinforcing their influence on the local society. Through OS-ID approach, the MBOs improve governance, service delivery, and advocacy capacities, enabling members – particularly **family farmers, waste picker entrepreneurs, women, youth, Indigenous and Black communities** – to **act as rights holders**, to act as rights holders who can participate in decision-making processes at local, state and national levels.

The programme aims to **promote the local new economies** (special the Amazon bioeconomy, recycling circular economy) by supporting sustainable and inclusive social businesses that generate decent work, diversify revenues, and strengthen local value chains, while also engaging the local stakeholder ecosystem to expand sustainable economic opportunities. By linking **organisational development with climate resilience and market access strategies**, MBOs **contribute to reducing inequalities** and strengthening the resilience of communities to economic, environmental, and socio-political conflicts. These efforts also strengthen human capital, as members gain skills, access to services, and improved economic opportunities.

By adopting a **bottom-up participatory approach**, the programme is particularly relevant in fragile and diverse contexts, guaranteeing the local led processes, social cohesion, prevent conflict, and opportunity to empower new/young leaders. Through connections with strategy stakeholders, alongside **leadership capacity building cycle** (with gender and youth inclusion lens) and thematics trainings (e.g. climate justice, new masculinities), **peer learning and exchanges, and advocacy strategies & methodologies** (e.g. FACT and Roadmap for Gender Mainstreaming tools), Trias will facilitate dialogue and coordination among parties, contributing to peacebuilding, trust-building, and inclusive governance systems.

The program also considers **rural-urban mobility dynamics**, recognizing that **climate injustices and limited economic opportunities drive migration**. With strengthening resilient livelihoods and inclusive local economies, the Brazil programme also complement is support to new circular economies in urban settings where are located part of those vulnerable migrants.

These interventions contribute to stability through three mutually reinforcing pathways: (i) **Inclusive and accountable governance**, strengthening MBOs as legitimate and professional interlocutors with key actors, a cornerstone of sustainability stability; (ii) **Human security, equity and managed mobility**, by embedding mobility within rights-based economic pathways that reduce distress-driven migration and promote social cohesion; (iii) **Local economic development and resilience**, through fairer circular economy models in urban areas and strengthened sustainable food & bioeconomy systems in rural and Amazonian territories, supported by inclusive digital tools that enhance skills, management and market access without exacerbating existing inequalities.

b) Strategic accelerators

o *Women and young people*

Trias adopts a **transformative and intersectional approach** to the empowerment of women, girls, and young people, positioning them as key actors in achieving inclusive, sustainable, and resilient entrepreneurship. Based on our Organizational Strengthening and Institutional Development (OS/ID) and 3Ps integrated approach, we aim to address the structural and systemic barriers that limit the full exercise of women's and young people's rights and opportunities. A link to human rights, frequently using the expression "**rights holders**" for specific groups we do not want to leave behind, to combat any type of gender-based violence.

Our intervention goes beyond increasing participation, economic access or isolated strategies with these vulnerable groups and right holders, but to the **transformation of unequal power relations**. This includes the strengthening of MBOs **inclusive governance** in climate-based organisations, promoting **equitable access to services & opportunities**, and in **developing skills**, such as: (i) supporting led climate solutions in rural-urban areas that include women and young people in decision-making spaces and processes of our MBOs; (ii) responses to climate migration that are based on an inclusive perspective of gender, youth, and other vulnerable groups; (iii) promoting sustainable and inclusive innovation and entrepreneurship ecosystems, to be led by young and women MBOs leaders; (iv) working with a focus on digital disparities and climate injustices, mainly affecting more women and young right holders in our MBOs partners; (v) developing actions that reduce youth unemployment through green and creative businesses.

In parallel, the programme will **facilitate methodological processes and tools** (e.g. the Trias Roadmap for gender mainstreaming, new masculinities & climate justice for youngsters trainings), providing **thematic advice** (especially on inclusivity), **build bridges & networks, peer learning**, and manage knowledge. A special **intersectionality** facilitation through **active, equitable, and structured involvement in decision-making processes**. Included, to improve the MBOs governance structural, policies, guidelines and decision-making workflows with gender and inclusivity lens.

Our intervention strategy also recognizes the direct links between gender inequality and climate change. Women and young people, particularly in vulnerable contexts, are disproportionately affected by climate impacts, while often facing structural barriers in accessing resources, technologies, decision-making spaces, and adaptation strategies. Reasons why specific **capacity building, training and peer learning exchanges** will be organised, together with Trias SAM region on specific thematic (e.g. climate justices), including **complementary strategies** with key stakeholders (e.g. youth inclusion through value chains, training cycles and innovative contests such as hackathons to introduce youngsters to startup and innovation ecosystems).

By positioning women and young people as co-creators, leaders, and innovators, the intervention strengthens their capacity for action and collective power, making gender equality and youth inclusion a central driver for achieving sustainable livelihoods and broader social impact.

o *Innovation*

From Innovation Uptake to Structural Stability

MBOs are positioned as **institutional anchors** capable of transforming innovation into collective resilience. Evidence shows that FFEs and informal NFEs are disproportionately affected by climate and market shocks; however, when organised collectively, they can pool risk, aggregate

data and negotiate more stable market relations. By strengthening the **research, innovation and management capacities of MBOs**, to address organisational instability. This includes: (i) collective adoption of digital tools for traceability (EUDR and due diligence; with steered of Trias Ecuador practices and Brazilian FGV university – previous AI Investment EU project), (ii) AI and digital literacy (with Meeting the Youngster platform, steered by Salchamber entrepreneur); logistics and environmental monitoring; (iii) organisational innovation that professionalises governance and decision-making; (iv) and shared ownership of data and knowledge, ensuring ethical and inclusive use

Strategic Innovation Vision Aligned with OECD and DGD Standards

In line with the OECD **Oslo Manual**, innovation is understood as a **systemic and cumulative process**, encompassing **product, process, organisational and marketing innovation**. Crucially, the programme positions innovation as an **accelerator of impact** for the global public goods of **climate, health and stability**. Innovation is not pursued as a stand-alone objective, but to: (i) reduce vulnerability to climate shocks, (ii) improve health outcomes through safer food systems and working conditions, and (iii) enhance economic and social stability in fragile territories.

Open-Innovation Hub and Diffusion

To act as a **bridge-builder**, connecting MBOs with universities, research centres, technology providers and financial institutions in Brazil and Europe (e.g. AWEX, Liege University with UFOPA and Unimontes; CERTI technological park in Belém and Consortium Bio Industry). Relevance to reinforce the existing **Europe–Brazil cooperation dynamics**, particularly in bioeconomy, agritech, digital infrastructure and low-carbon value chains, where expertise and territorial assets are complementary. Leveraging these ecosystems increases the likelihood that innovation investments translate into scalable, systemic outcomes rather than isolated pilots.

The program will also leverage the broad expertise and networks in Belgium like BRS, Vlerick Business School, Academics for Development volunteers, academic institutes, facilitating local and international exchanges through mutually beneficial partnerships with research institutions, private sector actors, and development partners. The team of Trias based in Brussels (Brussels Office and Trias Belgium participates in many networks and platforms in Belgium, such as PASA, Beyond Chocolate and The Shift, to establish the necessary contacts with adequate partners. These collaborations will support the co-creation, adaptation, and scaling of innovative solutions.

Innovation Targeting Climate, Health and Economic Sustainability

The programme explicitly aligns innovation priorities with quantified risks:

Climate adaptation and mitigation: by supporting low-carbon production systems, circular economy models and real-time monitoring of environmental assets—critical in a country where disaster-related displacement exceeded **1 million movements in a single year** (ICDM, 2025).

Health: Improved waste management, food quality and occupational safety directly address health risks in urban-rural territories, where environmental degradation and informality intersect.

Stability: Financial and organisational innovation, reducing income volatility and enhances predictability for thousands of cooperative members.

○ *Skills*

At the heart of our intervention lies the conviction that transforming rural-urban **rights-holders** into agents of change requires more than just technical assistance; it demands a strategic evolution of both **hard and soft skills**. While technical proficiency in agroecological systems for Amazonian communities or advanced solid waste management for urban recycling cooperatives provides the necessary foundation for economic viability, it is the cultivation of adaptive soft skills—such as inclusive leadership, fair market and advocacy negotiation, and systems thinking—that truly empowers family entrepreneurs to dismantle structural inequalities.

By prioritising **reskilling** and fostering a culture of **lifelong learning**, our programme ensures that our MBOs remain resilient in the face of climate volatility, shifting market dynamics, and new challenges based on the AI and connectivity revolution. In the Amazon, this means equipping traditional family farmers with the tools to defend territorial rights while navigating nature-positive value chains on the bioeconomy. In urban centres, it involves supporting waste-picker

networks to transition from informal labour to recognized providers of essential circular services.

This focus on skill-building is not a standalone activity but a fundamental pillar of our **Human Rights-Based Approach**. By strengthening the **internal capacities and governance frameworks** of these organisations (e.g. Farmer Advocacy and Consultation Tool – FACT, Leadership Trajectory Analysis – LEATRA and Building Resilience – BR I & II tools, including peer learning exchanges, technical capacity building & training, and other methodologies in partnership with key stakeholders), we bridge the gap between individual potential and collective impact. We ensure that these local voices possess the agency, competence, and authority to hold duty-bearers accountable and lead the transition toward a more just, resilient, and inclusive new economies.

Aligned to the strengthening of core capacities of our MBOs partners – through an Organizational Strengthening and Institutional Development (OS/ID) approach – **extra layers on hard and soft skills empowerment** of the MBOs members based and ways on how the programme will be implement is essential. Apart of training, exchanges and capacity building cycles, Trias will also develop the SPIDER monitoring tools in a jointly efforts with the MBOs leaders, improving their ownership on the institutional processes and long-term maturity.

On the ground of our intervention, it is the precondition of Trias' facilitation and advisory processes based on a **bottom-up, tailor-made and co-creative way**, including an inclusive and gender responsive lens. A systemic transformation based on the human-centred, as key true agents of transformation, influencing the growing maturity of our MBOs structures and their relationships towards internal member based & their local communities, but also with their external stakeholders ecosystem.

The added value of Trias lies in combining organisational strengthening **with multisectoral engagement** across the ecosystems that enable MBOs to thrive, grounded in a **systemic and decolonial perspective**.

c) Methodological approaches

o *A human rights-based approach, including decent work*

Trias adopts a Human Rights-Based Approach (HRBA) as the foundational lens for this intervention. Rather than a separate workstream, **HRBA is the "operational DNA"** that informs our context analysis, partnership dynamics, and program design. In a global landscape marked by shrinking democratic spaces and structural barriers, this approach is essential to transforming Member-Based Organisations (MBOs) into **powerful vehicles for social justice and economic inclusion**.

The programme's Theory of Change is built on a rigorous analysis of power relations and systemic inequalities. We recognize that rural and urban family entrepreneurs—particularly women, youth, vulnerable groups—are **not merely beneficiaries but rights-holders facing specific barriers to resources, information, and decision-making**.

By strengthening MBOs, we create collective platforms where these individuals transition from passive recipients to protagonists of their own development. Our focus is on institutionalizing inclusion through: (i) **Inclusive Governance**, facilitating the adoption of inclusive by-laws, leadership quotas, and participatory planning; and (ii) **Intersectionality in Action**, tailoring interventions to address overlapping vulnerabilities related to ethnicity and races, geographic isolation (such as remote Amazonian communities), and socio-economic status (e.g. waste pickers in big urban centres).

Trias promotes the right to decent work by positioning MBOs as central actors in equitable new economies (especially the Amazon bioeconomy and recycling circular economy). We bridge the gap between individual vulnerability and systemic stability by integrating labour rights and fair market negotiations into the entrepreneurial ecosystem. The intervention focuses on: (i) **Viable Business Models**, supporting women and youth-led ventures to ensure they are inclusive, climate-resilient, and economically sustainable; (ii) **Institutional Frameworks**, guiding MBOs to adopt formal governance that reflects values of fair trade, safe working conditions, and engagement with trade unions; and (iii) **Systemic Planning**, designing strategies through

community participation to ensure that market entry does not come at the cost of human dignity or environmental health.

We recognize that climate change is a human rights crisis that disproportionately impacts the most vulnerable. Our integrated approach reconciles **economic viability with climate justice**. Together with MBOs, we encourage resilient livelihoods by ensuring that women and youth are at the forefront of adaptation planning and resource governance. This ensures that the transition to a green economy is both inclusive and protective of the inherent rights of those most affected by environmental degradation. Central to our HRBA strategy is the engagement between rights-holders and duty-bearers. We strengthen the autonomy of MBOs to effectively advocate before public authorities and policymakers, ensuring the continuity of social progress. Aligned with the Trias commitment to “Local Voices, Global Impact,” we actively pursue a **decolonisation trajectory**. This means moving toward a **more balanced, horizontal partnership model** based on **co-creation and co-responsibility**. By consciously addressing power imbalances within our own partnerships, we create the necessary conditions for rights to be fully exercised, defended, and maintained over time.

- *Civic space (civil society and citizens)*

By the **Organisational Strengthening & Institutional Development (OS/ID)** Trias approach to strengthen the core capacities of our MBOs partners, there is an explicit contribution to a more **open, inclusive, and resilient civil society space**, where **democratic values** – based upon transparency, accountability, and active participation – are practiced and institutionalized. In Brazil, the member-driven organisations represent **key platforms** where the civil society organise, articulate their interests, and collectively engage in decision-making processes. In doing so, they not only model democratic practices internally but also gain legitimacy in demanding accountability and responsiveness from public institutions and local authorities.

In the Brazilian context, where local governance structures provide **formal spaces for citizen participation**, Trias-supported MBOs act as recognized civic actors. They unify and inform their members—family farmers, waste pickers entrepreneurs, women, youth, black and Indigenous Peoples—while strengthening their economic roles through new economies. This dual function—as economic actors and civic organisations—enhances their credibility and influence in engaging councils, committees, working groups, and networks stakeholders ecosystems.

Understanding the **potentiality and co-responsibility of stakeholders ecosystems** towards complex challenges in the Amazon bioeconomy and recycling circular economy, Trias will strategically support its MBOs partners on **lobby & advocacy and networking capacities**. Within a proven previous experience on lobby & advocacy approaches and by facilitating institutional processes (previous DGD programmes 2014-2016, 2017-2021), Trias expected to develop core capacities of MBOs leaderships and membership, based on key approaches. Recognised tools such as the Farmers’ Advocacy and Consultation Tool (**FACT**) to build up a bottom-up policy position towards local authorities and policy makers); including the Building Resilience Tool (**BR I and II**) to enable a grounded climate adaptation and livelihood planning.

To maximize effectiveness, initiatives should be guided by a clear strategic vision, supported by **structured planning and measurable indicators**. This allows for continuous learning, adaptation, and accountability, ensuring that efforts remain aligned with intended outcomes (all this assurance of maximizing effectiveness is presented in the skills and methodology section).

Partnering MBOs create direct and indirect impacts on the civil community, strengthening economic services and adding value, thus creating an entrepreneurial ecosystem. In this way, they become stronger and more relevant economic forces if they act at the political level. Furthermore, they play important roles in constructive engagement with diverse actors, from local to international, on issues involving development.

By fostering inclusive participation and empowering civil society, our Programme can enhance community resilience, support climate action, and build more stable and just societies for women and young people.

- *Triple Nexus: humanitarian, development and peace dimensions*

N/A

- *Common outcome or results between separate programmes*

N/A

- *Complementarity and synergy with the interventions of other channels of Belgian international cooperation*

This intervention strategically aligns with the **EU-Mercosur Partnership** and the momentum of the **2024 Belgian Economic Mission**, serving as a bridge between high-level trade policy and the operational readiness of local farmers entrepreneurs.

- **Market Readiness & Compliance:** As European standards like the **EU Deforestation Regulation (EUDR)** and OECD Guidelines become mandatory, Trias provides the "missing link" for MBOs (e.g. exchanging practices and expertise built by Trias Ecuador within their MBOs). We strengthen the technical capacities of Amazonian and urban cooperatives to meet these rigorous requirements, transforming regulatory barriers into competitive advantages for "forest-positive" products.

- **Commercial & Technical Innovation:** Building on successful precedents—such as the **Colruyt Group's** partnerships with Brazilian cooperatives (organic wild honey international trade)—the programme facilitates knowledge transfer between Belgian trade agencies (e.g., **AWEX and Liege University on Amazon gastronomy lab complementary initiative**), research institutions, and local MBOs. This fosters sustainable supply chains and introduces green technologies that enhance the viability of bioeconomy and circular ventures.

- **Climate & Social Justice:** By treating the **Paris Agreement** as a cornerstone of development, the intervention ensures that Belgian Brazilian trade supports biodiversity and territorial rights. We empower MBOs to reconcile economic growth with environmental guardianship, ensuring that international cooperation directly benefits the livelihoods of indigenous communities and traditional farmers.

D. Description of the programme, results and strategy

1. Description of the expected results

Description of the Outcomes

Programme Outcome:	Trias and MBOs partners are better equipped to fulfil their role as agents of change and contribute to a more inclusive, sustainable, and resilient entrepreneurial ecosystem in Brazil.
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Outcome indicator 1:	% Annual rural-urban MBOs revenues based on differentiated market(s) accessed
Type:	Quantitative – Outcome
Unit of measurement:	Percentage
Baseline:	1% increasing on annual MBOs revenues in differentiated market(s)*
Target year 3 – 31/12/2029:	10% increasing annual MBOs revenues in differentiated market(s)*
Target year 5 – 31/12/2031:	30% increasing annual MBOs revenues in differentiated market(s)*
Description of the indicator:	*This indicator measures MBOs' capacity to access differentiated markets under sustainability standards. Applies to rural (Amazon sociobiodiversity: açai, cocoa, coffee, cashew, honey), urban (CSA healthy food baskets, and recyclable materials: paper, plastic, metals, electronics) contexts. Criteria: (i) revenues channelled through the MBO; (ii) compliance with sustainability standards; (iii) documented proof (contracts, invoices, certification, traceability). Links to programme outcome and Outputs 1 (business development & market access), 2 (sustainable production), and 3 (inclusion and organisational strengthening).

Outcome indicator 2:	% of entrepreneurs adopting sustainable and resilient practices in their production systems or work environments
Type:	Quantitative – Outcome
Unit of measurement:	Percentage
Baseline:	10% increasing of family entrepreneurs adopting sustainable and resilient practices *
Target year 3 – 31/12/2029:	25% increasing of family entrepreneurs adopting sustainable and resilient practices *
Target year 5 – 31/12/2031:	45% increasing of family entrepreneurs adopting sustainable and resilient practices *
Description of the indicator:	*This indicator measures the percentage of MBO members (FFE and NFEs) who have adopted at least one sustainable or climate-resilient practice in their production systems or work environments. Applies to rural (agroforestry, organic fertilisation, water conservation, biodynamic practices), urban CSA (agroecological production, organic certification), and urban waste pickers (improved waste management, renewable energy, low-carbon processes). Criteria: (i) practice implemented for at least one productive cycle (or six months for waste pickers); (ii) adoption results from Trias-supported capacity building or technical assistance; (iii) verified through MBO records, technical visits, or traceability systems (e.g., compliance). Links to Output 2 (sustainable production) and Output 1 (market access).

Outcome indicator 3:	% of women and young people (18-30 years) occupying decision-making positions (boards, councils, committees) and actively participating in decision-making processes within MBOs
Type:	Quantitative – Outcome
Unit of measurement:	Percentage
Baseline:	15% of participation of women and young people in decision-making positions within MBOs, with low influence in governance processes *
Target year 3 – 31/12/2029:	30% of participation of women and young people in decision-making positions within MBOs *
Target year 5 – 31/12/2031:	50% of participation of women and young people in decision-making positions within MBOs *
Description of the indicator:	* This indicator measures the percentage of women and young people (18-30 years) in Brazil (Amazon region, urban CSA, and urban recycling contexts) who occupy decision-making positions within MBOs, and who effectively participate in organisational decision-making processes. Decision-making positions are those formally established in the organisational structure (boards of directors, commercialisation committees, technical committees, planning bodies, or institutional representation). It links primarily to Output 3 (inclusion and organisational strengthening) and complementarily to Output 1 (business development & market access).

Description of results/outputs

Output 1:	O 1. MBOs enhance members' market access by promoting higher-quality, differentiated, and value-added products/services, contributing to sustainable and competitive businesses
Output Indicator 1.1:	OI 1.1. Number of MBO members trained in technical workshops, training and seminars delivered to MBO members that strengthen capacities in business development, innovation and access to new economies
Type:	Quantitative – Output

Unit of measurement:	Numeric – Annual quantity of technical training, workshops, and exchanges
Baseline:	4 technical training, workshops, and exchanges organised on business development and access to differentiated markets *Limited structured training offered by the MBOs
Target year 3 – 31/12/2029:	15 training, workshops, and exchanges organised in at least 3 MBOs
Actual value – 31/12/2029:	
Target year 5 – 31/12/2031:	40 training, workshops, and exchanges organised in 4 MBOs
Actual value – 31/12/2031:	
Description of the indicator:	This indicator measures the annual number of MBOs members trained in technical workshops, training and seminars delivered to MBO members that strengthen capacities in business development (product quality, compliance and standards, due diligence, EUDR), innovation (added value, R&D on new products/services, AI and digitalisation) and access to new economies (especially bioeconomy and circular economy).

Output Indicator 1.2:	OI 1.2. Number of MBOs members unlocking differentiated markets on new economies
Type:	Quantitative – Output
Unit of measurement:	Number of members per MBO
Baseline:	374 MBOs members unlocking differentiated markets
Target year 3 – 31/12/2029:	747 MBOs members unlocking differentiated markets
Actual value – 31/12/2029:	
Target year 5 – 31/12/2031:	1.121 MBOs members unlocking differentiated markets
Actual value – 31/12/2031:	
Description of the indicator:	This indicator measures the annual number of MBOs members unlocking differentiated markets on new economies (especially bioeconomy and circular economy). Currently, market access limited; mostly informal or individual sales; structured services such as collective negotiation, quality control, or traceability systems are incipient.

Output 2:	O2. MBOs strengthen their members' climate resilience by promoting the adoption of sustainable climate practices, effective risk management strategies, and influencing the stakeholders ecosystem.
Output Indicator 2.1:	OI 2.1 Number of MBO members that have implemented climate risk management systems integrated into their businesses, including sustainable practices and climate adaptation measures.
Type:	Quantitative – Output
Unit of measurement:	Number of entrepreneurs/producers
Baseline:	747 entrepreneurs/producers systematically applying sustainable practices with practices implemented within affiliated MBOs)
Target year 3 – 31/12/2029:	1.868 entrepreneurs/producers implement sustainable practices
Actual value – 31/12/2029:	

Target year 5 – 31/12/2031:	3.736 entrepreneurs/producers implement sustainable practices
Actual value – 31/12/2031:	
Description of the indicator:	This indicator measures the annual number of MBO members that have implemented climate risk management systems integrated into their businesses, including sustainable practices and climate adaptation measures.

Output Indicator 2.2:	OI 2.2 Number of climate schemes and/or subsidies within MBOs that provide financial or in-kind compensation to members for adopting sustainable and climate-resilient practices.
Type:	Quantitative – Output
Unit of measurement:	Number of climate schemes and/or subsidies
Baseline:	0 (no formal PES or carbon market pilots operational within the 4 MBOs).
Target year 3 – 31/12/2029:	2 climate schemes and/or subsidies (at least one in the Amazon region – UNICAFES Pará or Rondônia – and one in urban context – UNICATADORES or CSA Brasil)
Actual value – 31/12/2029:	
Target year 5 – 31/12/2031:	3 climate schemes and/or subsidies (at least 100 members enrolled)
Actual value – 31/12/2031:	
Description of the indicator:	This indicator measures the annual number of climate schemes and/or subsidies (Payment for Environmental Services - PES, carbon market pilots, blended finances, biodiversity offsets, stewardship programmes) within MBOs, providing financial incentives to members for adopting sustainable and climate-resilient practices. Applies to: Amazonian farmers (carbon sequestration, forest conservation), waste pickers (emission reduction, recycling services), and CSA producers (soil and water conservation).

Output 3:	O3. MBOs strengthen economic inclusion and the leadership of women and young people as catalysts within the organization and the wider ecosystem through capacity building, effective participation, and expanded access to sustainable economic opportunities.
Output Indicator 3.1:	OI 3.1 Number of women, young people and EUE certified in inclusion & leadership strategies delivered by the MBOs to strengthen their capacities in leadership, business succession and governance.
Type:	Quantitative – Output
Unit of measurement:	Number of women, young people and EUE (entrepreneurial and underprivileged entrepreneurs)
Baseline:	1.308 women, young people and EUE certified in inclusion & leadership strategies
Target year 3 – 31/12/2029:	1.868 women, young people and EUE certified in inclusion & leadership strategies
Actual value – 31/12/2029:	
Target year 5 – 31/12/2031:	2.428 women, young people and EUE certified in inclusion & leadership strategies
Actual value – 31/12/2031:	

Description of the indicator:	This indicator measures the number of formal inclusion mechanisms institutionalised within MBOs to enable participation and leadership of women and youth in governance. Includes: quotas in statutes, gender/youth committees or secretariats, inclusive norms for decision-making spaces, and representation procedures.
Output Indicator (3.2):	OI 3.2 Number of active stakeholders in the (?) ecosystem, strategic alliances, and partnerships promoting the economic inclusion and leadership of women, young people, and EUE within MBOs decision making processes
Type:	Quantitative – Output
Unit of measurement:	Number of active ecosystem/alliances/partnerships (count per MBO)
Baseline:	2-3 ecosystem/alliances
Target year 3 – 31/12/2029:	6 ecosystem/alliances across 3 MBOs
Actual value – 31/12/2029:	
Target year 5 – 31/12/2031:	10 ecosystem/alliances across 4 MBOs
Actual value – 31/12/2031:	
Description of the indicator:	This indicator measures the Annual number of active stakeholders ecosystem, strategic alliances, and partnerships promoting the economic inclusion and leadership of women, young people, and EUE within MBOs decision making processes. Includes: public policy forums, private, civil society networks, academic partnerships, and international cooperation.

2. Description of the main activities and type of resources

For programme 2027-2031, Trias Brazil will implement a set of recurring, mutually reinforcing activities to deliver the programme outcomes, focused on: (i) OS-ID of MBOs; (ii) support to member organisations; and (iii) engagement with the stakeholder entrepreneurship ecosystem (markets, finance and enabling policies). Below is an explanation of what will be implemented, why, and how it contributes to results. The mix and intensity will be set through partner diagnostics, context/risk analysis and periodic learning reviews, aligned with Trias' Theory of Change and partners' starting capacities.

1. Organizational strengthening and capacity development

Based on OS-ID approach, Trias will support rural-urban MBOs to lead internal change that strengthens their governance, leadership, management systems and accountability, so they can deliver quality member services and act as collective change agents. Activities include organisational diagnostics; facilitated agile planning; training plus coaching/mentoring; reflection workshops; and technical to institutionalize systems (financial management, service delivery, advocacy and program-cycle management). Progress will be tracked through Trias tools: **SPIDER** (capacity), **LEATRA** (leadership), **GENDER ROUTE** (gender/youth inclusion) and **BR I & II** (climate/adaptation). MBOs implement reforms; Trias facilitates and provides inputs and limited catalytic support.

2. Technical advisory and entrepreneurship development support

Trias will provide technical advisory and facilitation support, to strengthen our MBOs core capacities and translate it into improved member livelihoods. Activities include strategic business planning; financial planning and performance review; inclusive value chain/market analysis; product/quality upgrading (and R&D of key products, in partnership of universities and research institutes); market linkages; improve services delivered to MBOs affiliates, and testing/scaling climate-resilient practices. Trias brokers expertise and partnerships; MBOs organise members, embed services and support adoption and scaling.

4. Workshops and Facilitation on program management

To ensure effective delivery and accountability, Trias will provide workshops and accompaniment on program management for MBO partners and Trias staff. Activities include annual/periodic planning; SPIDER/KM training; coordination and monitoring meetings; and joint reflection/dialogue (including assemblies) to review progress, risks and context changes and agree on course corrections. Trias will also strengthen partnership management (roles, reporting, accountability) and staff competencies through targeted training, coaching, peer learning and exposure.

5. Peer learning, knowledge management and scaling

To enable replication and scale-up, the program will invest in peer learning and knowledge management: peer exchanges/learning visits; thematic learning events; documentation of good practices/lessons; and practical knowledge products/tools (including digital where useful). Trias convenes and facilitates; MBOs share, host exchanges and apply/adapt proven practices.

6. Ecosystem engagement, advocacy and partnerships

To improve the enabling environment, Trias will support MBOs to engage duty bearers and ecosystem stakeholders and key actors (local governments, markets, civil society and knowledge institutions) through dialogue, partnerships and advocacy. Activities include stakeholder mapping and engagement planning; participation in multi-stakeholder platforms; evidence generation and issue framing based on members' priorities; and structured advocacy and policy dialogue. Trias will facilitate these processes, including use of **FACT** (Farmers Advocacy Consultation Tool) to consolidate issues and develop evidence-based messages. MBOs represent members, lead local engagement and follow through on commitments.

Across components, Trias will sequence and adapt implementation through continuous monitoring, reflection and learning, aligning resources with partner needs, the pace of institutional change and opportunities to scale.

3. Target groups and beneficiaries

Target groups

Our *direct* target group are a selected mix of 4 MBOs, representing urban-rural, national and state MBOs of farmers and non-farmers family entrepreneurs. We focus on both on MBOs of FFEs and NFEs.

- **UNICAFES Pará**, 2nd level in developing rural MBO, 13 farmers cooperatives in Pará state, from the Amazon biome (Northern Brazil).
- **CSA Brasil**, 3rd level in developing rural-urban MBO, 200 CSA units (in 19 states, from 5 Brazilian regions).
- **UNICATADORES**, 3rd level mature MBO, 230 recycling cooperatives (in 26 states, from 5 Brazilian regions).
- **UNICAFES Rondônia** (Exit strategy in 2028), 2nd level in developing rural MBO, 16 farmers cooperatives in Rondônia state, from the Amazon biome (Northern Brazil).

Our *indirect* target group are the member-entrepreneurs of these 4 MBOs.

The programme will reach **3,736 direct beneficiaries**, aiming at 50% Women and 30% youth (staff, leaders, key members of the MBOs). Approximately 70% of the partner budget will be allocated to the Farmer oriented MBOs and the remaining to entrepreneurial waste pickers cooperativism.

Beneficiaries – Rights holders

In total all the members of the 4 MBOs is estimated in total 56.646 member people, from which 3.046 FFEs and 53.600 NFEs. As **indirect beneficiaries, a total of 242.605 people** (FFEs and NFEs).

- **UNICAFES Pará:** 1.241 FFEs (from all 13 cooperatives), 29% of women and 15% of youth; including 2 staff.
- **CSA Brasil:** 540 FFEs and 3.600 NFEs (from all 200 CSAs units), 70% of women and 30% of youth; including 3 staff.
- **UNICATADORES:** 50.000 NFEs (230 recycling cooperatives), 60% of women and 30% of youth; including 28 staff.
- **UNICAFES Rondônia:** 1.265 FFEs (from all 16 production cooperatives), 56% of women and 30% of youth; including 2 staff.

4. Change theory of the country programme (→ appendix 1)

5. Risk analysis (→ appendix 2)

6. Description of the tasks of the cooperating organisations

N/A

E. Explanation of the OECD criteria, involvement of the partners, synergies and how lessons learned were taken into account

a) OECD criteria

1. Description of relevance

Brazil stands at a decisive crossroads where its substantial potential as a global leader in the green transition intersects with deep-seated internal structural fragilities. While the country is often assessed through aggregate economic performance, recent evidence points to a **slowdown in human development**, reflecting stagnation in social indicators despite economic recovery (UNDP, 2024). This trend is compounded by a **"triple squeeze"**: constrained external financing, growing trade tensions and the rapid automation of labour markets, which disproportionately affect low-skilled and informal workers (World Bank, 2023).

In this context, Brazil's relevance for this programme is within the convergence of three structural agendas decisive for the country and for Trias in South America: Amazon bioeconomy, circular economy, and sustainable food systems. Each one offering opportunities for inclusive economic development, climate resilience and biodiversity protection, but each also has a risk: if organised family farmers, waste pickers, women, young people are not positioned as actors with voice, services, market access and negotiating power, the transition may reproduce the same inequalities it claims to solve. Hence, the programme strengthens Member-Based Organisations and to be capable of making these emerging ecosystems more inclusive, democratic, sustainable and resilient.

Global and Current Shocks Affecting Vulnerable Groups

Large-scale global transformations are amplifying existing vulnerabilities and disproportionately affecting Brazil's most exposed populations:

- Rural–Urban Migration and Food Systems Pressure: Climate-related shocks are accelerating **internal displacement and rural–urban migration**, leading to the erosion of local agricultural knowledge, rising food production costs and dependence on external supply chains (IFAD, 2023). Climate projections for Brazil indicate potential temperature increases of up to **4.5°C by the end of the century**, posing serious risks to staple crop yields and directly threatening food security for smallholder farmers (MCTI, 2023).
- Waste Pickers and the Circular Economy Transition: Brazil's transition towards a **circular bioeconomy** has profound implications for the livelihoods of waste pickers, who play a central role in urban solid-waste management. The **National Bioeconomy Plan 2026–2035** stresses the importance of scaling community-based enterprises and strengthening grassroots organisations as part of a socially inclusive transition (MMA, 2026).

Despite their relevance, many waste pickers continue to work under conditions close to **analogous labour**, characterised by informality, unsafe environments and chronic income insecurity. Without deliberate corrective action, the circular economy risks reinforcing structural exploitation and value capture by intermediaries (IPEA, 2022).

Internal Displacement and Climate Vulnerability

Extreme weather events are producing large-scale displacement. In **2024 alone**, floods in Rio Grande do Sul resulted in approximately **775,000 internal displacements**, with disproportionate impacts on Indigenous and Afro-Brazilian communities facing compounded socio-economic vulnerabilities (IDMC, 2025).

Bioeconomy, Technological Change and Equity

The **National Bioeconomy Plan 2026–2035** recognises Indigenous peoples, traditional communities and family farmers as **essential stewards of biodiversity** and central actors in sustainable development strategies. Their participation is not merely social but structurally necessary for conservation, climate mitigation and resilient territorial economies.

Simultaneously, the rapid expansion of **digitalisation and artificial intelligence** introduces new inequalities. Without corrective public and cooperative action, technological benefits tend to concentrate among actors with pre-existing access to infrastructure, capital and skills, deepening exclusion among informal and community-based workers (World Bank, 2023).

By aligning with the **COP30 Action Agenda** and Brazil's national transition frameworks, Belgium can contribute decisively to closing climate finance gaps and advancing **nature-based solutions** that are socially just and territorially grounded (UNFCCC, 2022). The objective must not only be emissions reduction, but the active reduction of **overlapping vulnerabilities** related to poverty, climate exposure and weak institutional protection.

Circular Economy and Urban Waste Picker Cooperatives

Transforming discarded waste into technically viable secondary raw materials requires structural investment in **collective organisation, transparency and bargaining power**. Strengthening UNICATADORES enables to move beyond marginal roles as low-paid suppliers and to claim dignified remuneration for the environmental services they provide. This is particularly critical in a market dominated by powerful intermediaries, whose lack of transparency by cooperative labour and perpetuates the sector's structural invisibility.

While digital systems, traceability tools and AI-based solutions are increasingly vital to transparency and to preventing greenwashing, they also carry a risk of exclusion if applied without social safeguards. Working through UNICATADORES ensures that technology is deployed as an **inclusive enabler**, rather than as an instrument of displacement or unprotected automation, directly addressing low digital literacy levels across the sector.

Equally critical is the absence of structured **leadership and capacity-building pathways**. Women represent most of the workforce in waste picker cooperatives yet remain under-represented in decision-making, while young people increasingly exit the sector due to limited prospects. These challenges are compounded by low schooling levels, territorial violence, gender inequality and the economic impossibility of unpaid training. Supporting UNICATADORES allows these constraints to be addressed holistically through integrated leadership development, inclusive technology adoption and transparent governance—laying the foundation for a **just, inclusive and credible circular economy**.

Healthy Food Systems as a Foundation for Global Health Sustainability

Unhealthy diets are among the leading global health risk factors, contributing to more than **18 million premature deaths annually**, while over **two billion people experience moderate to severe food insecurity**, primarily due to structural failures in food systems rather than absolute food shortages (UN DESA, 2025). In Brazil, particularly in large urban centres and Amazonian territories, health outcomes are increasingly shaped by the interaction between food systems, environmental degradation and socio-economic inequality. Despite the existence of a universal public health system (SUS), **upstream determinants of health**, remain insufficiently addressed, fueling the rise of diet-related non-communicable diseases (NCDs) and long-term pressure on primary healthcare systems (PAHO, 2022).

The Programme approaches **Global Health through food systems as a preventive and structural entry point**. In the Amazon, climatic instability, logistical isolation and elevated transport costs limit access to fresh food, while ultra-processed products dominate local markets. Through **UNICAFES**, the Programme strengthens cooperative governance, food safety standards, agroecological technical assistance and integration with public procurement mechanisms such as **PNAE and PAA**, directly contributing to food security, child nutrition and the resilience of local health systems.

In urban contexts, **Community-Supported Agriculture (CSA) model, CSA Brasil MBO**, reconnects consumers and producers, ensures stable access to seasonal agroecological food and promotes **Food and Nutrition Education**. By empowering consumers, shortening food chains and stabilising farmer livelihoods, the Programme reduces long-term NCD risk factors, strengthens social cohesion and contributes to resilient, equitable and **preventive global health systems**.

X

X

2. Description of coherence

The proposed outcome is fully consistent with, and builds upon, more than **twenty years of support to solidarity-based cooperativism in Brazil through the UNICAFES system**, internationally recognised for its contribution to inclusive economic development, food security and democratic governance. Trias' long-term engagement constitutes a clear comparative advantage, grounded in territorial anchoring, cooperative enterprise strengthening and policy-aligned advocacy.

The coherence of continuing support in Northern Brazil is justified by the scale and specificity of the **Legal Amazon**, which presents structural constraints related to distance, infrastructure, market access and institutional capacity. In response, Trias has progressively adopted a **territorial reference approach**, successfully consolidating cooperative ecosystems in selected regions. In the North, Rondônia has emerged as a proven reference, demonstrating tangible results in bioeconomy value chains, local market integration and logistics.

In line with the **Leave No One Behind principle** and the Theory of Change, **expanding this approach to Pará** is both relevant and necessary. Despite the presence of multiple actors, significant gaps persist between conservation objectives, bioeconomy strategies and viable, cooperative-led enterprises. It addresses this gap without duplication, complementing existing initiatives by reinforcing cooperative organisation as a lever for inclusive, climate-compatible economic development.

Coherence with the local stakeholder ecosystem is ensured through complementarity with **INGOs** (The Nature Conservancy & GIZ), **universities & research institutes** (UFOPA, CERTI), **private sector actors** (Colruyt Group & Suzano), and **federal programmes** (Coopera Brasil and National Bioeconomy Plan – MDA and MMA ministries). Trias' added value lies in consolidating a robust territorial reference, facilitating dialogues among key international actors to promote the access to **blended finance PPP partnerships** (AgriCord alliance, KBS coop, IFAD), thereby contributing to shared objectives for sustainable food systems and climate action.

Regarding relevant international standards and criteria, Trias is a signatory of the UN Global Compact and ensures a thorough ethical due diligence check for every new partner or donor. Trias formally recognises the IATI standard, which is embedded in our Accountability and Transparency framework.

Complementary approach on rural-urban settings

The proposed outcome complements its existing rural entrepreneurship and sustainable food system intervention in Brazil, built upon another **inclusive organisational model** with rural-urban

MBO CSA, by supporting the expansion of **Community Supported Agriculture (CSA)** as a complementary pathway to solidarity-based cooperativism.

The intervention addresses a specific **gap in the peri-urban context of big cities such as São Paulo and Rio de Janeiro**, where vulnerable producers and consumers remain excluded from formal markets, collective economic organisation and public policies, aggravated due to **rural-urban migration, AI digitalisation gaps and job displacement**. Unlike cooperative-focused interventions, the CSA model prioritises food and nutrition education, shared risk between producers and co-farmers, and territorial links between family farming and marginalised urban groups. This distinct focus avoids duplication and reinforces the **Leave No One Behind** principle by engaging actors not yet able to organise as cooperatives.

Prior to the DGD programme 2022-2026, no **CSA initiatives existed in the North**. It is a proven model to be upscaled to underserved regions, while to maintain the CSA consolidation in major metropolitan areas such as Rio de Janeiro and São Paulo.

Internal coherence is ensured through complementarity with Trias' support to solidarity cooperativism: CSA initiatives create entry points into collective action and food sovereignty, to improve in more concrete and sustainable perspective its services to its affiliated CSAs. External coherence is reinforced through structured **collaboration** with CSA Brasil's partners, including **public-private-academy partnerships** (Instituto Mahle, Urgenci Learning Hub, VP consultancy, UEM university, and AFD Belgian volunteers), each contributing specific expertise in organisational development, education and governance.

Organising the Waste pickers Cooperativism toward a more inclusive Circular economy

The proposed outcome is coherent in strengthening solidarity-based cooperativism, under the umbrella organisation UNICOPAS (representing UNICAFES, UNISOL, CONCRAB, UNICATADORES), beyond the family farming cooperativism movement, extending institutional support to **recycling cooperatives within UNICATADORES**. The specific feature of this outcome lies in its focus on waste pickers' cooperatives as key actors in the **circular economy**, addressing a gap not sufficiently covered by infrastructure- or market-driven initiatives. Despite their essential contribution to environmental services and climate mitigation, waste pickers remain structurally marginalised, facing informality, exploitation by intermediaries, weak organisational capacity and limited access to public policies. The intervention addresses these systemic constraints through institutional strengthening, leadership development, gender and youth inclusion (55% of women members), and evidence-based advocacy.

Strategic complementarities will be ensured by supporting **South-South cooperation initiatives** (LACRE Network), reinforced by established **ecosystem of public-private-civil-society actors** (ANCAT, UNICOPAS, and reverse logistics private companies involved in Extended Producer Responsibility – EPR and the National Solid Waste Policy – PNRS). This clear division of roles avoids duplication and ensures added value, while Trias contributes organisational expertise, international networking and advocacy support.

3. Description of effectiveness

The programme is designed to achieve its expected outcomes by strengthening **MBO partners as primary agents of change** on the ecosystems. This logic is applied in Brazil through three connected pathways: Amazon bioeconomy, circular economy and sustainable food systems.

The **Seven Trias Partnership Commitments** reinforces the collaboration with partner MBOs. **Local leadership** ensures that priorities and trajectories are defined with the MBOs and not imposed. **Mutual accountability** and transparency support co-responsibility for results. Co-creation and learning are reflected in the six-month dialogue and planning process with partner MBOs. Equal partnership and awareness of power dynamics are particularly important in a programme that aims to shift ownership and strengthen local agency. This is also why Trias' role is not reduced to funding activities; Trias acts as facilitator, thematic advisor, bridge builder, peer-learning facilitator and catalytic financier.

Trias partners choices in Brazil

Partner choice is a key effectiveness factor, working with a differentiated but coherent portfolio related to maturity, systemic role, regional mandate and co-financing potential: **UNICAFES Pará, CSA Brasil, UNICATADORES, and UNICAFES Rondonia**. UNICAFES Pará and Rondonia leads the Amazon bioeconomy pathway and support MBOs in organisational strengthening, business generation, climate resilience, representation and access to opportunities. CSA Brasil contributes through community-supported agriculture, connecting producers, co-farmers/consumers and local actors around sustainable food systems, food and nutrition education and short market circuits. UNICATADORES contributes through the organisation and recognition of waste-picker cooperatives as economic, social and environmental actors in circular economy systems.

Important changes compared to the previous programme: (i) Reduction and consolidation to avoid strategic dispersion and ensure deeper support, (ii) more differentiated roles and “value chain anchor” logic (from main local value chains such as Amazon fruits to amplify the social economic development of local businesses), and (iii) a stronger emphasis on partners’ maturity and systemic influence. Besides, the exit strategy with Cresol and UNICAFES National illustrates the shift toward equal partnership, amplifying new ways of collaboration with mature MBOs.

Programme goals

The programme outputs need to be understood as organisational change processes rather than isolated deliverables with expected results close linked to the outcome and include, inter alia:

- **Output 1** focuses on MBOs improving services for market access thru quality improvement, value-added and sustainable and competitive businesses development.
- **Output 2** focuses on MBOs integrating climate resilience, environmental sustainability.
- **Output 3** focuses on MBOs institutionalising inclusive governance, women’s and youth leadership, member participation and reduced dependency mechanisms.

By clearly distinguishing between outcomes (organisational change and agency) and impact (broader socio-economic and systemic change), the initiative avoids attribution gaps and ensures methodological coherence in monitoring, evaluation and learning.

Evidence-Based and Usable Baselines

After the **6-months co-creation** phase with current and new MBOs (Nov/2025 to Apr/2026), it was established a baseline each of the MBOs, based on the 6 core capacities, with indicators, as well as the 5-years cycle goals of Trias’ intervention.

These baselines for each outcome are established through the **SPIDER approach** (“Strengthening Partners in Development through Empowerment and Reflection”), a **participatory, bottom-up and structured organisational capacity assessment tool** involving the leaders & members of our MBO partners. It allows to jointly **assess strengths and weaknesses across core capacity domains**, define priority change trajectories and select relevant performance indicators that are expected for over the 5-years cycle (2027-2031).

The baselines were co-produced with leaders, staff and members of the partner organisations. This increases ownership and makes them fully usable for interim and final evaluations, as well as for impact assessments. Annual self-assessments and progress reviews enable longitudinal analysis of change and provide robust evidence of effectiveness over time.

Trias facilitates this reflection process and supports a more advanced prioritisation exercise if necessary. This process ensures the MBO ownership (important criteria for the desired changes/outcomes described in our logframe & ToC), as well as the realistic and achievable nature of the work plan & its related objectives. MBOs and Trias expect to work closely in **6 core capacities**: (i) Inclusion, (ii) environment, (iii) governance, (iv) financial Health, (v) integrated Services, and (vi) advocacy. They will be monitored annually, considering the quantitative and qualitative indicators, including an intermediate-term evaluation of our ToC will be expected, as well as adaptive management through outcome harvesting, timeline exercises and contribution analysis. This is an assessment to highlight the intervention scope, the path for the goals achieved, and an impact assessment at the beneficiaries level

OS/ID Trias Approach & Leave No One behind Principle:

Our intervention based on an organisational strengthening and institutional development (OS/ID) approach aims to empower people in our societies, bringing their voices to the forefront.

MBOs will be accompanied by Trias to acknowledge the social inequalities present in their environment and actively work to dismantle them to create a fairer society for all. However, some situations might require the review of existing privileges & benefits and how to continue an efficient collaboration to address the root causes of oppression.

We explicitly **prioritise**, together with MBO partners **vulnerable groups – women, youth and economically underprivileged members**. Effectiveness is therefore assessed not only by aggregate results but also by differentiated outcomes across population groups, in line with the **“Leave No One Behind” principle**. This is operationalised through:

- disaggregated indicators (by gender, age and socio-economic status);
- affirmative measures to reduce structural barriers to participation and leadership;
- targeted capacity development to ensure that underrepresented groups can influence organisational decisions and access services equitably.

The programme will use disaggregated data by sex and age and will support targeted measures where structural barriers limit participation, leadership or access to services. In waste-picker cooperatives, this means recognising the role of women and young people in circular economy while addressing informality and decent work. In Amazonian family farming, it means ensuring that women and young people are not excluded from commercialisation, finance, climate adaptation and governance opportunities. Effectiveness will therefore be judged by changes in influence and access, not only by attendance in activities.

Cascading and Sustainable Effectiveness & Trias key roles

The programme's **cascading logic** strengthens feasibility. **Trias' OS/ID approach** works simultaneously at **several levels: key individuals inside MBOs, organisational systems, member services and ecosystem relationships**. Improvements at organisational level translate into better services, stronger representation and increased resilience for thousands of individual entrepreneurs, generating cumulative and sustainable results beyond the programme cycle. Moreover, Trias' specific contributions to:

- Strategic thematic advisory (climate and biodiversity, new sustainable economies –linked to businesses development and access to markets of MBOs partners, innovation, inclusion).
- Process facilitation using OS/ID and SPIDER methodologies.
- Bridge-building and network mobilisation, especially leveraging Belgian, European and regional private sector, diplomatic and academic networks.
- Knowledge management, generating regional learning loops across Trias South America MBOs.

Strengthened Multi-Stakeholder Ecosystem and Innovative Finance Logic

The ecosystem approach is essential because MBOs cannot address structural barriers alone. Public institutions can contribute to enabling frameworks, procurement, recognition and policy dialogue. Private actors can contribute to market access, product development, responsible sourcing and co-investment. Financial actors can contribute to credit, guarantees, investment readiness or climate finance where feasible. Research and innovation actors can contribute to data, traceability, environmental monitoring and product development.

The new programme aims to deepen Brazil's successful experience in building local–national–international coalitions and responds to lessons learned from MBO co-investments capacity and fundraising diversification, highlighting:

- Unlocking new blended-finance fundings and innovative financial mechanisms
- Closer cooperation with private sector, leveraging DGD funding rather than using it as primary funding
- Greater emphasis on solidarity finance modalities, beyond credit cooperatives models, including other new low-cost fintech partnerships, revolving funds, corporate ESG agendas, and climate-oriented instruments.

The programme recognises the potential of climate finance, PES, carbon pilots, biodiversity incentives, circular economy service contracts, ESG agendas and blended finance, but it will not assume automatic access. Effectiveness requires a sequence: readiness, evidence generation, feasibility checks, organisational capacity, partnership development, pilots where possible, and

access where conditions allow. At the same time, more immediate financial sustainability pathways will be strengthened: service-based models, commercialisation support, co-financing, resource mobilisation, financial governance and partnerships with mature allies such as Cresol and UNICAFES National.

Risks and mitigation as part of feasibility and effectiveness

The programme's effectiveness is reinforced by explicit risk management, as detailed in appendix 2. Key risks include shifting government priorities in bioeconomy policies, the climate finance gap, accelerated rural-urban migration, high staff turnover, AI-driven exclusion of vulnerable groups, climate disasters, and land tenure complexity. Mitigation measures include diversifying alliances, strengthening MBO advocacy capacities, unlocking blended finance, prioritising youth succession programmes, developing staff retention and knowledge management systems, promoting digital literacy, developing contingency plans and insurance partnerships, and providing legal experts to assist with environmental service contracts.

It has a realistic approach once it combines a clear causal logic, a limited set of measurable indicators, partner-owned planning through co-creation and SPIDER, a monitoring and learning system designed for adaptive management, explicit integration of inclusion and the Leave No One Behind principle, proactive risk management, and the cascading logic of Trias' key roles. These elements – tested in the previous cycle, validated by the Mid-Term Evaluation, and strengthened for 2027-2031 – provide a credible basis for achieving the expected results and contributing to a more inclusive, sustainable and resilient entrepreneurial ecosystem in Brazil. Its effectiveness will be judged not only by activities delivered, but by whether MBOs become more capable, inclusive, financially sustainable and influential in the systems that shape their members' livelihoods.

4. Description of the expected impact

Each programme outcome contributes to sustainable and transformative impact for the target groups—UNICAFES Pará, CSA Brasil, UNICATADORES and UNICAFES Rondônia—as **key agents of change**. These organisations represent family based agricultural producers and non-agricultural entrepreneurs, with a strong focus on women and youth. The intervention assumes that **strengthening urban-rural membership-based organisations** (MBOs), while **transforming their economic ecosystems**, will lead to durable livelihood improvements and resilience.

Economic impact is achieved by improving income stability and growth through increased volume and value of products marketed via differentiated Amazon bioeconomy value chains, including coffee, cocoa, açai, cashew nuts, honey and other sociobiodiversity products. This strengthens market positioning, reduces dependence on volatile intermediaries and enhances service delivery, particularly within urban circular economy systems in Rio de Janeiro and São Paulo.

Social impact results from enhanced agency, participation and decision-making power, especially for women and youth, contributing to the reduction of structural inequalities within organisations and territories.

Environmental impact stems from the adoption of climate resilient practices such as agroforestry, biodynamic production and integrated value chains, supporting ecosystem restoration, reducing climate vulnerability and improving long term productivity in Pará and Rondônia. The programme also enables pilot initiatives in carbon markets and payments for climate services, benefiting both farming and non-farming enterprises.

At the **system level**, strengthened coordination among rural urban MBOs, public institutions and market actors influence norms, practices and incentives, improving access to services, finance and policy spaces and enabling replication beyond direct beneficiaries. Overall, the intervention addresses root causes of poverty, exclusion and environmental degradation, contributing to improved well-being, gender equality, human rights and environmental sustainability.

5. Description of sustainability

The programme is designed to ensure that social, institutional, economic, environmental and capacity related benefits are embedded within MBOs, partner relationships and ecosystem

structures, maximising the likelihood that results are sustained and further developed over the medium and long term. Sustainability is pursued through four interlinked dimensions: social, institutional, economic financial and environmental.

Social sustainability is strengthened through a **bottom up and participatory approach** in which members, leaders and governing bodies jointly define priorities, approve strategic plans and monitor progress. Inclusive strategies ensure the effective participation and representation of women, youth and other vulnerable groups in governance, services and advocacy. Democratic practices reinforce ownership, collective accountability and long-term commitment to results, reducing dependency on external actors.

Institutional sustainability is a central pillar. The programme works with legally recognised MBOs that represent their members through **formal governance structures**. Capacity building focuses on strengthening management systems, strategic planning, monitoring and evaluation, and accountability mechanisms. Support to key individuals is embedded into organisational routines, policies, service models, financial management and strategic decision making, reinforcing institutional resilience and ownership.

Capacity building enhances the abilities required to sustain results over time, including: (i) **analytical capacities** to understand social inequalities, climate risks and market dynamics; (ii) **leadership and governance capacities** for inclusive decision making; (iii) **service delivery capacities** to address members' economic and social needs; and (iv) **advocacy capacities** to influence policy processes. These capacities enable MBOs and their members to adapt to changing contexts and continue generating benefits beyond the programme period.

Economic and financial sustainability is pursued by strengthening service-based models, business generation, commercialisation, value addition, financial governance, resource mobilisation and engagement within entrepreneurial ecosystems. MBOs are supported to access public policies, grants and budgetary instruments through structured advocacy. Climate finance, PES, carbon related mechanisms and blended finance are explored where feasibility, governance and partner capacity allow. This diversified financing approach **reduces vulnerability to external shocks** and increases long term resilience.

Environmental sustainability is promoted through climate resilient economic models, including **bioeconomy, circular economy and low carbon value chains**. Practices such as agroecology, agroforestry, recycling and sustainable production contribute to mitigation and adaptation while maintaining or increasing incomes. Where applicable, these practices are linked to **Payment for Environmental Services (PES) and carbon mechanisms** to align environmental benefits with economic incentives.

Partnership evolution and exit strategy foresee a **gradual shift from direct support to facilitation, networking and strategic accompaniment**. As partner autonomy increases, Trias' role evolves into connecting MBOs to platforms, networks and policy spaces, ensuring they retain the capacity to sustain results independently.

Multiplier effects through the Training of trainers (ToT) logic, by disseminating knowledge, sustainable practices and advocacy engagement across the MBOs membership based, staff and their networks. To scale benefits beyond direct beneficiaries and the possibility to institutionalise the knowledge internally.

Overall, the programme demonstrates a high likelihood that net benefits will be sustained over time through strengthened institutions, empowered actors, diversified financing, resilient environmental practices and reduced dependency on external support.

b) [Partner involvement, synergies and 'learning forward'](#)

6. [Description of the role of the partners \(new\)](#)

MBO Partners as Anchors for Systemic Change

The programme is designed to achieve its outcomes in a realistic, measurable and sustainable manner by strengthening **MBO partners as primary agents of change**. Partnerships are grounded in shared values, **mutual reinforcement, co-responsibility for results and long-term**

engagement. Trias' partnership policy is operationalised through the **Seven Partnership Commitments** – *Local Voices, Global Impact*, ensuring that partners retain strategic leadership over priorities and change processes, while Trias contributes facilitation, advisory support, network access and temporary financial means where relevant. These are **equal partnerships** based on trust and **joint accountability**, extending beyond financial relationships to ensure sustainability beyond the programme period.

Bottom-Up and Integrated Approach

In reference to the Trias Partnership Policy, the programme was co-designed through a **six-month dialogue and co-creation phase** (Nov 2025–Apr 2026) with MBO partners, ensuring that **problem analysis and strategic priorities** are **rooted in partner-led evidence**. Using Trias' SPIDER OS/ID methodology, partners conducted participatory assessments of organisational capacities, jointly establishing baselines, priority change trajectories and measurable indicators for 2027–2031.

Partners are responsible for: (i) translating agreed priorities into member-oriented services, advocacy actions and organisational reforms; (ii) ensuring outreach and representation through democratic structures; (iii) mobilising members and local stakeholders at territorial level; and (iv) monitoring progress through annual self-assessments and joint learning processes. Trias' role is complementary and clearly delimited, acting as process facilitator, thematic advisor, network broker and temporary supporter without substituting partner leadership or decision-making authority.

MBO Partnership choice

The **selected MBOs** represent a **balanced mix of maturity levels, territorial mandates, and competencies**, ensuring coverage across rural-urban contexts. In addition, Trias will tailor its role according to each MBO's needs and lessons learned. For third-level MBOs, this includes facilitating strategic themes at the corporate level, building partnerships, and identifying complementary funding opportunities. For first-level MBOs, Trias will focus on advising pilot initiatives and supporting the upscaling of successful practices.

- **UNICAFES Pará:** Rural, 2nd level developing MBO – anchor for Pan-Amazon bioeconomy, cooperativism model expansion, climate resilient agriculture, and innovative finance mechanisms. Emphasis on 13 1st level cooperatives in Pará, with special attention to Amazon sociobiodiversity products (açaí, cashew nuts and honey) and key commodities (cocoa and café, linked to Peru and Ecuador).
- **CSA Brasil:** Rural-urban, 3rd level developing MBO – anchor for healthy food education, circular economy, peri-urban vulnerability, and community-supported agriculture models. Emphasis on Northern 1st level CSA units).
- **UNICATADORES:** Urban, 3rd level mature MBO – anchor for lobby & advocacy, capacity building and training for leadership (especial attention to youth and women), digital connectivity, circular economy, and urban and climate resilience.
- **UNICAFES Rondônia (exit strategy in 2028):** Rural, 2nd level developing MBO – anchor for Pan-Amazon bioeconomy, cooperativism model expansion, climate resilient agriculture, and innovative finance mechanisms. Emphasis on 15 1st level cooperatives in Rondônia, with special attention to Amazon sociobiodiversity products (açaí, cashew nuts and honey) and key commodities (cocoa and café, linked to Peru and Ecuador).

Territorial and Sectoral Focus

Operations concentrate on the **Amazonian corridor (priority to Pará, with targeted actions in Tocantins and Rondônia) and major urban centres (Rio de Janeiro and São Paulo)**. Shared priorities include Trias South America commodities (coffee and cocoa), Amazon sociobiodiversity products (açaí, cashew nuts, honey), resilient food systems, bioeconomy and circular economy models, peer-to-peer learning, knowledge systematisation and coalition-building with public authorities.

Future Readiness and Innovation

Trias integrates future-readiness as a **cross-cutting dimension**, including women and youth leadership, inclusive governance, digital connectivity and AI-enabled innovation, environmental transition and decarbonisation strategies, food security and sovereignty, blended finance

mechanisms and responses to urban vulnerabilities linked to climate migration and labour transitions.

Exit Strategy and Multiplier Effects

For consolidated third-level MBOs, Cresol and UNICAFES National, Trias will progressively transition from operational partner to equal peer and strategic stakeholder, expanding fundraising and collaboration opportunities. UNICAFES Rondônia will follow a **gradual exit**, remaining engaged until 2028 to support regional synergies. As representative organisations, the four MBOs act as multipliers by disseminating knowledge, promoting sustainable practices and engaging in advocacy, scaling benefits beyond direct beneficiaries.

7. Description of synergies

The new Trias programme is built on strengthening high-impact synergies among Belgian organisations, Amazonian MBOs, academic institutions, private sector actors, and public stakeholders in Brazil and the wider Amazon and Andean regions. These partnerships are central to advancing an inclusive and regenerative Amazon bioeconomy, promoting innovation, youth employment, climate action, and sustainable market access, while reinforcing the leadership of MBOs as key stewards of sociobiodiversity.

Academic–Private–Public Partnerships for the Amazon Bioeconomy

A flagship initiative is the academic–private partnership with **AWEX** through the **IBD Gastronomy Lab Amazonia Programme**, a regional programme integrated into the **IDB Amazon Forever Programme**. This initiative is under the leadership of the **Inter-American Development Bank (IDB)** and jointly developed with **Trias South America**, **La Conexión**, and **Instituto Regenera**. This partnership builds on a continuous multi-stakeholder dialogue initiated during preparations for the **COP30 Amazon Taste Panel**, and provides a strategic platform to: (i) Increase the visibility of MBO partners from Brazil, Peru, and Ecuador; (ii) Position them as key actors in conserving, regenerating, and valorising Amazonian sociobiodiversity; (iii) Promote long-term coherence in the Amazon bioeconomy, moving beyond the “forest standing” narrative toward sustainable value chains, innovation, and inclusive markets.

Academic Exchange, Research, and Innovation Ecosystems

The programme will further leverage **new consortium modalities**, including **ERASMUS+ and other European university programmes**, to strengthen academic cooperation and applied research. Together with key Brazilian stakeholders—such as **CERTI** (an innovation and research hub based in Belém, Pará) and **Unimontes University**—Trias will expand academic exchanges grounded in long-term partnerships. This includes collaboration with **UNICAFES member Coopemapi**, based on years of cooperation in beekeeping business development. These initiatives aim to foster: (i) Research and innovation linked to MBO value chains; (ii) Knowledge transfer and dynamic capabilities; (iii) Internships, volunteer exchanges, and applied learning opportunities.

The programme builds on successful experiences with **KU Leuven** and **Academics for Development (AFD)**, supporting short-term Belgian and European internships and volunteer programmes that connect urban and rural MBO initiatives in Brazil.

Private Sector Engagement and Youth Employment

Private sector engagement is being significantly expanded through **Salchamber**, following the **Royal Belgian Economic Mission to Brazil (2024)**, which gathered over 400 Belgian entrepreneurs, academics, and business leaders. This engagement enables Trias and its MBO partners to strengthen cooperation with: (i) The **Belgian diplomatic network** in Brazil (Embassy and Consulate); (ii) Belgian trade and investment actors, including **FIT**, **AWEX**, **Hub.Brussels**, and **Belgalux**.

Planned joint activities include workshops, networking events, and seminars involving MBO partners, reinforcing Trias’s role as a facilitator of a **Belgium–Brazil multi-stakeholder**

ecosystem around shared agendas such as climate action, ESG, corporate social responsibility, blended finance, carbon markets, and international trade.

A key focus is **youth employment**, leveraging Salchamber's **AI-based employment platform** to connect vulnerable urban youth—particularly those affected by rural–urban migration—with traineeships and first formal job opportunities. Early private sector partners under dialogue include **Engie, Suzano, and the Coca-Cola Institute**.

International Trade and Long-Term Partnership with Colruyt Group

A long-standing partnership with **Colruyt Group** anchors international trade and youth inclusion within the programme. This partnership is structured around:

- **Wild honey international trade**, involving **Coopemapi, Meli**, and the Colruyt Sustainability Department;
- **Youth inclusion in beekeeping**, supported by the **Colruyt Group Foundation**, now in its fourth joint project.

The current phase expands to include two additional Amazonian cooperatives—**Acosper (Pará)** and **Cooafeto (Tocantins)**—with co-participation from **Suzano**, a Brazilian cellulose & paper company.

With the first Colruyt Group mission to Brazil and South America planned for **June 2026**, and strategic dialogues with the **Secretary for Local Territories (MTDR)**, **APEX Brazil (MAPA)**, and **UNICAFES National**, new opportunities are emerging to upscale Belgium–Europe–Brazil trade that directly benefits MBOs and final beneficiaries. These efforts build on proven results, including: (i) Participation in international healthy food fairs (e.g. **Expo East, Philadelphia**); (ii) First exports to Europe (e.g. **Coopemapi wild honey**); (iii) institutional partnership between **APEX Brazil and the UNICAFES system**, enabling nine family farming cooperatives to participate in a major healthy food fair in Dubai (first half of 2026).

EU–Mercosur, Climate Finance, and Blended Finance

Beyond individual value chains, the programme aligns with emerging opportunities under the **EU–Mercosur framework**, integrating international trade, technology transfer, and compliance with EU standards such as **EUDR requirements, traceability, and due diligence**.

On the climate agenda, Trias will continue advancing joint efforts on: (i) Carbon-neutral value chains, (ii) Carbon markets, and (iii) Innovative **blended finance mechanisms**.

In collaboration with **KBC Coop, AgriCord, Cresol, IFAD**, and other partners, the programme promotes new cooperation modalities that place **MBOs at the centre of fundraising, knowledge management, and partnership governance**.

In 2026, Trias and **Cresol**—a mature MBO and former Trias/DGD partner—jointly organised a seminar showcasing partnership results and future opportunities, grounded in Trias's **seven commitments to equitable partnerships**. Under the new programme, these experiences will be scaled to unlock innovative finance and strengthen public–private–academic ecosystems that support a resilient, inclusive, and regenerative Amazon bioeconomy.

The Programme 2027–2031 is grounded in lessons learned of the previous DGD/Trias programme, external evaluations, and shared learning processes. Learning was consolidated through PME systems, external assessments, strategic dialogues and structured learning pathways with MBOs and key stakeholders. These lessons support the move from broad partner support towards a more focused ecosystem approach centred on MBO-led pathways in the Amazon bioeconomy, circular economy and sustainable food systems.

- Inclusive, accountable and resilient organisations: Implementation experience and evaluations demonstrated that inclusion delivers sustained impact only when embedded in governance, leadership and decision-making structures. In response to these findings, Trias supported institutional reforms within MBOs, strengthening parity mechanisms, youth engagement and leadership pathways linked to accountability. These lessons inform the

2027–2031 focus on leadership mindset change, generational renewal and the consolidation of inclusive governance as a core organisational function.

- Economically sustainable and service-oriented MBOs: Learning from evaluations, peer exchange and cost-efficiency analysis confirmed that MBO sustainability depends on coherent service-based models rather than fragmented or project-driven interventions. Trias therefore prioritised advisory support related to commercialisation, financial governance, logistics and value-chain positioning, while progressively reducing direct operational financing for mature organisations and increasing co-financing requirements. For the new cycle, follow-up to these lessons includes stronger financial KPIs, selective market expansion, clearer board accountability and a deliberate avoidance of over-extension across territories or partners.
- Climate justice and environmentally sustainable food systems: Shared learning across programmes highlighted the limited effectiveness of stand-alone environmental actions. In response, climate agendas were institutionalised within MBOs through governance structures, national mappings and territorially anchored pilots. These actions strengthened systems thinking and enabled MBOs to engage more strategically in policy and climate dialogues. For 2027–2031, lessons learned inform the upscaling of proven approaches (e.g. Trias tools such as Building Resilience I & II, new masculinities, gender tool kit, climate justice training), stronger youth engagement in climate justice, improved access to climate finance and alignment with international frameworks such as COP30.
- Learning, monitoring and adaptive management: Trias PME reviews and external evaluations confirmed the need for decision-supporting, learning-oriented monitoring systems. Trias reinforced participatory PME tools, facilitated reflective learning processes and strengthened partner ownership of data. Building on this, the next programme cycle will operationalise learning through clearer outcome-level KPIs, shorter feedback loops and tighter integration between PME and strategic dialogue.
- Partnerships, complementarity and coherence: Lessons learned demonstrated that structured partnerships significantly enhance relevance, outreach and coherence. Trias strengthened collaboration with Belgian cooperation actors and public-private-academic partnerships, positioning MBOs as credible interlocutors in policy and market arenas. For 2027–2031, follow-up includes more systematic partnership management, formalised MoUs for complementary fundraising and structured post-dialogue follow-up mechanisms, in line with Trias commitments and donor expectations.

F. Country programme budget

1. T4 – Operational costs

2. Explanation of the budget (standard text from SAM – Hector/Mayra)

Budget Rationale and Allocation

The programme budget is designed to maximise value for financial investment, by prioritising actions that generate structural and sustainable change in MBOs and their economic ecosystems.

The intervention targets approximately **3.736** rights holders, ensuring gender parity and strong youth participation (30%).

The resources will prioritise, based on Trias integrated approach:

- Business development and market access, through investments in quality, differentiation, applied studies, standards and strengthened special services;
- Climate resilience and environmental sustainability, including risk assessments, technical assistance and the adoption of resilient productive practices; Inclusive organisational development, with dedicated funding for gender equality, youth leadership, and the applied use of digital tools and artificial intelligence to reduce the digital divide;
- Ecosystem strengthening, functional partnerships and public policy advocacy.

Trias' South America and Brazil Offices, play a facilitative and coordinating role, ensuring technical coherence, articulation among the stakeholders ecosystem and learning management. The **total five-year budget** amounts to **€ 1.411.469,58**, from which allocation distribution will follow the rationale distribution of: **20,34% for South America Trias Regional Office, 60,29% for Brazil Office, and 19,37% for 4 MBOs**, ensuring an efficient balance between direct support to organisations and programme coordination, while delivering economic results, climate resilience, social inclusion and systemic change.

Overview of main chart of accounts for total budget:

1. Investments: € 4.300,00
2. Operational costs: € 531.455,00
3. Personnel: € 864.662,00
4. Other costs: € 11.053,00

Financial Architecture: Strategic Mechanisms of Co-funding

To maintain institutional financial health and ensure donor diversification without depleting liquid reserves, Trias puts in place the following co-funding mechanisms: **i. Valorisation** (strategic overlap of budgets between two core projects), **ii. Valuation** (pro bonus by professional time of experts, volunteers, and board members and **iii. Donations** (Bound Income from consultancy assignments or direct donations from private individuals, foundations, and companies

Stakeholder ecosystem for collaboration and synergies

Apart of the cofinance modalities, to amplify the funds diversification and new opportunities, at Trias worldwide, South America Region, and Brazilian perspectives, are eager to extend the **stakeholders ecosystem**, promoting together with key partners and stakeholders' logic of consortiums, complementarities, and synergies. Win-win partnerships with key actors from public-private-academic levels, inspired by Trias track record with stakeholders.

Based on different approaches to develop new public-private-academic relationships, Trias is developing the strategic dialogues and complementary projects on resource mobilization.

G. List of partnerships and collaborations (including budgets)

1. Partnerships
2. Collaborations

II. Mandatory appendices

1. Theory of change linked to the outcome

Available on Annex 1

2. Risk analysis related to the outcome

Available on Annex 2

3. Descriptive sheet per partners

Available on Annex 3

4. Descriptive sheet per partnership

Available on Annex 4

5. Country programme outside JSF: context analysis

N/A for Brazil

6. Country programme outside JSF: coherence with the organisation's strategic plan

Brazil's current political landscape is characterised by deep polarisation, institutional disputes and challenges in implementing public policies against a backdrop of persistent inequalities. Furthermore, the attacks on the seats of the three branches of government in January 2023 exposed institutional weaknesses and the radicalisation of political groups, sparking debates on the defence of democracy and the role of institutions².

Since the election of Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva in 2022, there has been an attempt to rebuild social and environmental agendas, following a period of great political instability during the government of Jair Bolsonaro³. Despite institutional instability and fragility, issues such as environmental governance, particularly in relation to the Amazon, and the resumption of Brazil's leading role on the international stage have gained prominence on the government's agenda.

The current government has played a significant role in reviving and strengthening **environmental and food security policies** in Brazil. On the environmental agenda, the restructuring of regulatory and enforcement bodies stands out, as does the reinforcement of international commitments aimed at reducing deforestation, particularly in the Amazon, which has contributed to the recent decline in deforestation⁴ rates and to the country's repositioning in global forums. These measures indicate an attempt to rebuild environmental governance and promote sustainable development⁵.

In the field of **food security**, the government has resumed public policies aimed at combating hunger and poverty, notably the relaunch of the Bolsa Família programme and the reactivation of the National Council for Food and Nutritional Security⁶. These initiatives aim to expand access to adequate food, strengthen family farming and reduce social inequalities, particularly considering the recent worsening of food insecurity⁷ in the country.

In the field of **gender policies**, one of the main initiatives was the re-establishment and strengthening of the Ministry of Women, with the aim of coordinating actions aimed at gender equality and tackling violence against women⁸. The government has also made progress on legislation regarding equal pay for men and women, requiring greater transparency from companies⁹. These actions signal a resumption of public policies focused on gender equality and social inclusion.

Regarding **family farming**, the Government has prioritised increasing funding and strengthening structural policies. The launch of the Family Farming Harvest Plan has allocated billions in rural credit, with reduced interest rates and incentives to produce staple foods, with the aim of expanding the food supply and ensuring food security¹⁰. Furthermore, policies such as the strengthening of the National Programme for the Strengthening of Family Farming (PRONAF, in Portuguese) and the expansion of public procurement and technical assistance programmes have contributed to income generation in rural areas and the productive inclusion of small farmers¹¹.

Another significant step forward was the enactment of a law expanding the National Family Farming Policy, incorporating guidelines on innovation, sustainability and technological development, which reinforces the modernisation of the sector¹². Initiatives focused on agroecology and the transition to

² AVELAR, Lúcia; CINTRA, Antônio Octávio (org.). Sistema político brasileiro: uma introdução. São Paulo: UNESP, 2015.

³ HUNTER, Wendy; POWER, Timothy J. Bolsonaro and Brazil's illiberal backlash. *Journal of Democracy*, v. 30, n. 1, p. 68–82, 2019.

⁴ OBSERVATÓRIO DO CLIMA. Relatório Anual do Desmatamento no Brasil. São Paulo, 2023.

⁵ ABRAMOVAY, Ricardo. Infraestrutura para o desenvolvimento sustentável. São Paulo: Elefante, 2019.

⁶ CONSEA – Conselho Nacional de Segurança Alimentar e Nutricional. Relatórios e diretrizes institucionais. Brasília, 2023.

⁷ REDE PENSSAN. II Inquérito Nacional sobre Insegurança Alimentar no Contexto da Pandemia da COVID-19 no Brasil. São Paulo, 2022.

⁸ MINISTÉRIO DAS MULHERES. Políticas públicas para igualdade de gênero. Brasília, 2023.

⁹ GOVERNO LULA (2023). Políticas de direitos humanos e igualdade de gênero.

¹⁰ BRASIL. Governo Federal. *Plano Safra 2023/2024*. Brasília, 2023.

¹¹ CONTAG. *Governo anuncia R\$ 77 bi para a agricultura familiar para a Safra 2023/2024*. 2023. <https://ww2.contag.org.br/governo-anuncia-r-77-bi-para-a-agricultura-familiar-para-a-safra-2023-2024-e-entrega-respostas-a-pauta-do-grito-da-terra-brasil-20230628>.

¹² SENADO FEDERAL. *Lei nº 14.828/2024 e a ampliação da Política Nacional da Agricultura Familiar*. Brasília, 2024. <https://www12.senado.leg.br/noticias/materias/2024/03/21/lula-sanciona-lei-que-amplia-politica-nacional-da-agricultura-familiar>.

sustainable production systems also stand out, promoting environmental preservation and the resilience of food systems¹³.

In general, there is an effort towards institutional reconstruction and the prioritisation of social and environmental agendas, repositioning Brazil both domestically and on the international stage as an actor committed to inclusive and sustainable development¹⁴. In this sense, the contemporary Brazilian political landscape can be understood as a period of institutional reconstruction¹⁵ and the redefinition of priorities.

That said, government action seeks to integrate social, economic and environmental policies, recognising that food security is directly linked to the sustainability of production systems and the preservation of natural resources¹⁶. In other words, the Lula government's actions point towards a development strategy that combines social justice, productive inclusion and sustainability, recognising the central role of women and family farming in reducing inequalities and combating hunger in the country.

Regarding current trends and opportunities within the national context, we can highlight several key themes relevant to the DGD 27-31 Programme:

1. Amazonian bio corridors

This topic has been gaining prominence in environmental and development debates in Brazil, particularly due to its ability to integrate environmental conservation, social inclusion and income generation. These corridors¹⁷ consist of connections between protected areas, indigenous lands and zones of sustainable use. The corridors¹⁸ promote a systemic approach, coordinating different land uses – conservation, production and habitation – within the same territorial space.

Furthermore, there has been progress in **multi-sectoral governance**, involving governments, local communities, the private sector and international organisations. Recent projects show that the development of these corridors¹⁹ depends on participatory and decentralised processes, which strengthens the legitimacy and effectiveness of environmental policies. The Amazonian bio corridors in Brazil point towards a new development paradigm: not merely protecting the forest, but using conservation as a foundation for **economic innovation, social inclusion and global climate leadership**.

In the economic sphere, the bio corridors²⁰ pave the way for strengthening the bioeconomy, based on the sustainable use of biodiversity. This includes production chains for forest products, biotechnology and agroforestry systems, which combine environmental conservation with income generation for local populations.

There are also significant opportunities for **smallholder farming and traditional communities**, as many corridor projects²¹ include technical assistance, institutional strengthening and incentives for sustainable practices, such as extractive activities and agroecology. These models help to reduce poverty and increase socio-economic resilience in the region.

Another important point is the potential to attract **international funding**, particularly through climate funds, payment mechanisms for environmental services and impact investments. The conservation of

¹³ MINISTÉRIO DO DESENVOLVIMENTO AGRÁRIO. *Programa de inovação e agroecologia para a agricultura familiar*. Brasília, 2024. <https://www.gov.br/mda/pt-br/noticias/2024/12/decreto-presidencial-cria-programa-que-preve-acoes-de-pesquisa-e-inovacao-para-a-agricultura-familiar-e-agroecologia>

¹⁴ ABRAMOVAY, Ricardo. *Infraestrutura para o desenvolvimento sustentável*. São Paulo: Elefante, 2019.

¹⁵ POWER, Timothy J.; ZUCCO JR., Cesar. *Polarization and democracy in Brazil*. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2023.

¹⁶ FAO – Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations. *The State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World*. Rome: FAO, 2021.

¹⁷ BRASIL. Governo Federal. Projeto Corredores Ecológicos – PCE. Brasília, 2026. Disponível em: <https://www.gov.br/mma/pt-br/assuntos/biodiversidade-e-biomas/gestao-integrada-de-paisagem/corredores-ecologicos/projeto-corredores-ecologicos>.

¹⁸ Bahia. Inema – Instituto Do Meio Ambiente E Recursos Hídricos. Corredores Ecológicos. 2026. <https://www.ba.gov.br/inema/programas/projeto-corredores-ecologicos>.

¹⁹ BRASIL. Governo Federal. Projeto Corredores Ecológicos – PCE. Brasília, 2026. Disponível em: <https://www.gov.br/mma/pt-br/assuntos/biodiversidade-e-biomas/gestao-integrada-de-paisagem/corredores-ecologicos/projeto-corredores-ecologicos>.

²⁰ Portal Amazônia. Caminhos sustentáveis: como a infraestrutura verde impulsiona a bioeconomia na região amazônica. 2025 <https://portalamazonia.com/amazonia-ameaca-ou-oportunidade/caminhos-sustentaveis-amazonia/>

²¹ Amazônia. Corredor ecológico da biodiversidade. 2026. Disponível em: <https://www.amazoniabr.org/pt/conservacao-e-desenvolvimento-sustentavel/corredor-ecologico-da-biodiversidade/>

the Amazon, integrated with ecological corridors, is viewed globally as strategic for climate stability, which increases interest from investors and multilateral organisations.

2. Climate Migration and Internal Displacement

The current context of **climate migration** in Brazil is characterised by a significant increase in internal displacement caused by extreme weather events, although the issue remains largely unaddressed in public policy.

There has been a consistent rise in the frequency and intensity of **extreme events**—such as droughts, floods, landslides and wildfires—which are having a direct impact on population mobility. Furthermore, climate migration in Brazil occurs predominantly as internal and short-distance movement, that is, within the same municipality or region, reflecting the adaptation strategies²² of vulnerable populations, particularly smallholder farmers affected by droughts and crop losses.

Another key factor is the interaction between **social vulnerability and climate risk**. Regions such as the North and Northeast tend to bear the brunt of the impacts²³, due to a combination of structural poverty, inequality and greater exposure to extreme weather events. This scenario reinforces the unequal nature of climate migration, disproportionately affecting already vulnerable populations, such as rural communities, indigenous peoples and residents of urban peripheries.

Nevertheless, projections indicate that the phenomenon is likely to intensify in the coming decades, as Brazil faces growing climate risks²⁴ and a higher incidence of extreme events, such as prolonged droughts, heavy rainfall and forest fires.

Conversely, opportunities to work on this issue are also growing, particularly as the topic intersects with agendas on climate, social development, urban planning and human rights. It remains a field in the process of consolidation, which means there is real scope for innovation — but it also requires the capacity for coordination between different sectors.

Civil society organisations play a central role, particularly in the most exposed regions (the North and North-East). In relation to this issue, the following are opportunities for work: support for communities affected by droughts, floods and disasters; programmes for **resilient livelihoods** (e.g. climate-adapted agriculture); initiatives with displaced populations in urban peripheries; production of territorial assessments; development of climate migration indicators; evaluation of public policies; opportunities with projects funded by climate funds and partnerships with agencies such as the International Organisation for Migration and the United Nations Development Programme; integration with gender, race and indigenous peoples' agendas; initiatives focused on the development of green infrastructure in vulnerable urban areas; and agroforestry systems and ecological restoration.

Working on climate migration in Brazil today means operating in an **interdisciplinary and expanding field**, with opportunities both in responding to crises and in preventing displacement.

3. Artificial intelligence, digitalisation and young people

The intersection between **artificial intelligence (AI)**, digitalisation and young people represents one of the most dynamic and strategic fields today, particularly in countries such as Brazil, where there is a large young population and digital access is expanding rapidly. This scenario presents both opportunities and structural challenges, particularly regarding social and economic inclusion.

One of the most striking trends is the **democratisation of AI technologies**²⁵, driven by accessible platforms developed by companies such as Google, which allow young people to use advanced tools without the need for complex infrastructure. This has broadened access to content creation,

²² Instituto mobilidade e desenvolvimento social. Política Social e Resiliência: Uma análise geoespacial do impacto das mudanças climáticas nas decisões de migração entre produtores agropecuários vulneráveis. 2025. https://imdsbrasil.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/03/ImdsA009_2025_PoliticaSocialResiliencia.pdf

²³ Fiocruz. Desastres climáticos afetaram mais de 336 mil pessoas no Brasil em 2025. 2026. <https://cee.fiocruz.br/desastres-climaticos-afetaram-mais-de-336-mil-pessoas-no-brasil-em-2025/>

²⁴ Centro Celso Furtado. Levantamento de desastres ambientais no Brasil e custos reportados. 2025. https://centrocelsofurtado.org.br/wp-content/uploads/2025/11/Relatorio_CICEF_iCS_Nov2025.pdf.

²⁵ OECD. *OECD Digital Economy Outlook 2022*. Paris: OECD Publishing, 2022.

programming, automation and data analysis, contributing to new forms of entry into the labour market²⁶.

Another significant trend is the focus on **digital education** and future-ready skills, with an emphasis on computational thinking, AI literacy and socio-emotional skills. Young people are at the heart of this process, acting as both beneficiaries and key players in the digital transformation²⁷.

In terms of opportunities, AI and digitalisation are paving the way for new careers, as well as fostering **digital entrepreneurship**²⁸ and remote working in global markets. For social projects and public policies, there is great potential in **digital inclusion** programmes, the use of AI in education (such as personalised learning) and technological training for young people in vulnerable situations.

However, significant challenges remain, such as **inequality in digital access**. These challenges, in turn, represent opportunities for action in public policy, research and social innovation. The convergence of AI, digitalisation and youth points to a future in which young people not only adapt to technological changes, but lead processes of **economic innovation and social transformation**, provided there is consistent investment in education, inclusion and technological governance²⁹.

4. Sustainable business and the European- Mercosur Union Agreement

Although the trade agreement between Mercosur and the European Union is still in the process of ratification, it has the potential to significantly reshape opportunities for **sustainable business** in Brazil, particularly by aligning international trade with stricter environmental and social standards.

One of the main opportunities lies in the **expansion of sustainable exports**. The agreement³⁰ provides for tariff reductions on various products, which could benefit production chains that already adopt good environmental practices, such as low-carbon agriculture, organic products and sustainable forest management. These are some business opportunities to develop with our partners, ensuring compliance with strict criteria on traceability, zero deforestation and environmental certifications, which encourages us to invest in sustainability as a competitive advantage.

Another important trend is the strengthening of the **bioeconomy**, particularly in the Amazon. Biodiversity-based products – such as food, cosmetics and pharmaceutical inputs – are gaining prominence in the European market, which values sustainable and socially responsible supply chains. This opens opportunities for businesses that integrate local communities, indigenous peoples and technological innovation³¹.

The agreement also drives opportunities in the field of **green technologies and the energy transition**. Other opportunities include expanding the range of partnership possibilities, such as in the sectors of renewable energy, green hydrogen, the circular economy and emissions reduction.

Overall, the agreement between Mercosur and the European Union is likely to accelerate the **integration of trade and sustainability**, favouring companies and projects that can align economic competitiveness with environmental and social responsibility. This scenario paves the way for the promotion of **sustainable family farming**, particularly with certified and traceable products. Short supply chains, fair trade and agroecological production are likely to gain greater visibility, benefiting small-scale producers who can access international markets with institutional and technological support³².

²⁶ BRYNJOLFSSON, Erik; MCAFEE, Andrew. *The second machine age: work, progress, and prosperity in a time of brilliant technologies*. New York: W. W. Norton & Company, 2017.

²⁷ OECD. *OECD Digital Economy Outlook 2022*. Paris: OECD Publishing, 2022.

²⁸ BANCO MUNDIAL. *World Development Report 2021: Data for Better Lives*. Washington, DC: World Bank, 2021.

²⁹ UNESCO. *Reimagining our futures together: a new social contract for education*. Paris: UNESCO, 2021.

³⁰ EUROPEAN COMMISSION. *EU-Mercosur trade agreement: key facts*. Brussels, 2023.

³¹ ABRAMOVAY, Ricardo. *Infraestrutura para o desenvolvimento sustentável*. São Paulo: Elefante, 2019.

³² FAO – Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations. *The State of Food and Agriculture*. Rome: FAO, 2021.

III. Optional appendices

1. Map of the country indicating the location of the intervention

2. Acronyms

ACRONYMS (in alphabetical order):

3 P's – People, Planet and Profit

ACOSPER - Cooperativa dos Trabalhadores Agroextrativistas do Oeste do Pará

AFS - Agroforestry Systems

COOAFETO - Cooperativa de Produção e Comercialização dos Agricultores e Agricultoras Familiares do Estado do Tocantins

COOPEMAPI - Cooperativa dos Apicultores e Agricultores Familiares do Norte de Minas

CSA Community Supported Agriculture

FACT – Farmer Advocacy and Consultation Tool

HRBA - Human Rights-Based Approach

LEATRA – Leadership Trajectory Analysis

LNOB - Leave No One Behind

MBOs - Member-Based Organisations

MSC - Most Significant Change

OD - Organizational Development

ODP - Organizational Development Plan

OSID - Organizational Strengthening and Institutional Development

PEP - Pluriannual Strategic Plan

PNRS - National Solid Waste Policy

POA - Annual Operational Plans

PSA - Projeto Saúde e Alegria

REP - Extended Producer Responsibility

SDGs - Sustainable Development Goals

SEBRAE - Serviço Brasileiro de Apoio às Micro e Pequenas Empresas

TNC - The Nature Conservancy

ToC - Theory of Change

UNICATADORES - União Nacional de Catadores e Catadoras de Material Recicláveis do Brasil

UNIMONTES - Universidade Estadual de Montes Claros